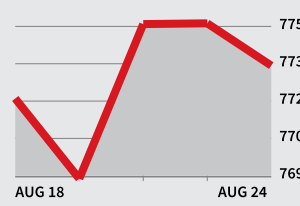


the hindu businessline

SENSEX 77369.11 (-171.72)



IN FOCUS

	LATEST	CHANGE
Nifty 50	24219.05	-32.95
P/E Ratio (Sensex)	20.50	-0.04
US Dollar (in ₹)	95.74	+0.05
Gold Std 10 gm (in ₹)	161505.00	+1528
Silver 1 kg (in ₹)	245391.00	-1239

GROWTH ENGINE.

With India's real growth around 7%, SBI can grow credit 13-14% and overall balance sheet by 12%, says Chairman CS Setty **p2**



TAKING OFF.

Private operators set to infuse ₹8,622 cr in 11 AAI airports to be leased out in five bundles **p12**

BENGALURU - CHENNAI - COIMBATORE - HUBBALLI - HYDERABAD - KOCHI - KOLKATA - MADURAI - MALAPPURAM - MANGALURU - MUMBAI - NOIDA - THIRUVANANTHAPURAM - TIRUCHIRAPALLI - VIJAYAWADA - VISAKHAPATNAM

Regd. TN/ARD/14/2012-2014, RNI No. 55320/94

QUICKLY.

BULLION RUSH
Gold ETFs see fifth straight week of inflows



Chennai: Inflows into physically backed gold exchange-traded funds (ETFs) remained positive for a fifth consecutive week as investors found gold prices above \$4,500/oz attractive. World Gold Council data showed the US and the UK led the investments in the week ended August 21. Inflows totalled \$7.56 billion, against outflows of \$1.18 billion. **p7**

POLICY REVERSAL
Govt lifts ban on wheat, atta, maida, suji exports

New Delhi: After four years, the government on Monday lifted the ban on export of wheat and wheat-based products, including *atta*, *maida*, semolina, wholemeal *atta* and resultant *atta*, as record domestic production and comfortable supplies eased food security concerns. The DGFT shifted the export policy for wheat, durum wheat and wheat or *meslin* flour products from “prohibited” to “free”, with immediate effect. **p10**

CEO exits rise at India Inc, stocks feel investor heat

TERM CUTS. Nearly 42% of MD/CEO departures in FY26 came before the end of their terms

Sindhu Hariharan
Sourashis Banerjee
Chennai

India Inc is seeing a rise in CEOs exiting before completing their terms, with some departures causing investor unease, as reflected in stock price movements.

The number of Nifty500 company chiefs who exited rose sharply in FY26, with nearly 42 per cent leaving before completing their terms.

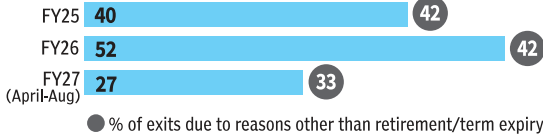
A *businessline* analysis of MD/CEO exit data from *primeinfobase.com* showed 40 exits in FY25, 52 in FY26 and 27 between April and August of FY27. At this pace, FY27 could surpass FY26.

Of these exits, 42 per cent in FY25 and 33 per cent in the first five months of FY27 involved CEOs leaving pre-term for reasons including “personal reasons”, “pre-occupation”, “change in role” and succession planning. The data track exits of Nifty 500 MD/CEOs who are also board members.

Within the non-retirement category, financial services recorded the most

Top level exodus

Number of exits of MD/CEOs also on board



Key MD/CEO exits in FY26 and FY27

Name of exiting MD/CEO (company)	Share price change after 1-week of announcement (%)
Pradeep Kumar Bakshi (Voltas)	-5.4
Sumant Kathpalia (IndusInd Bank)	-0.6
Rohit Jawa (Hindustan Unilever)	4.2
Anup Kumar Saha (Bajaj Finance)	-7.2
Varun Berry (Britannia Industries)	-4.9
Siddharth Mittal (Biocon)	-4.7
Suren Jain (Jaiprakash Power Ventures)	16.6
Sudhir Sitapati (Godrej Consumer Products)	-9.2
Prabha Narasimhan (Colgate-Palmolive India)	-0.5

Source: *bl*. analysis of exits of MD/CEOs data from *primeinfobase.com*

exits, with six in FY26 against three in FY25. Consumer discretionary and FMCG also accounted for six exits each in FY26.

RISK SIGNAL

Market reaction to CEO exits has generally been negative, suggesting investors

view leadership departures as a risk signal rather than a routine event.

In seven of nine key non-retirement exits in FY26 and FY27, stock prices fell in the week following the announcement.

For instance, Sudhir Sitapati's exit from Godrej

Consumer Products, announced on August 11, 2026, led to the stock price falling 9.2 per cent over the week. Similar impactful exits were of Anup Kumar Saha from Bajaj Finance and Pradeep Kumar Bakshi from Voltas, which led to the respective stocks falling by 7.2 per cent and 5.4 per cent in the first week of the announcement.

COMPLEX ROLE

Shiv Nath Ghosh, Chief Commercial Officer, Professional Talent Solutions, Randstad India, said, “AI-led transformation and geopolitical volatility, among other things, are compressing the window in which leaders are expected to deliver results.”

Kamal Karanth, Founder of specialist staffing firm Xpheno, said CEO churn in the consumer sector is driven largely by shifts in market dynamics and consumer behaviour rather than performance issues.

Consumer durables and goods companies have faced margin pressures, intensifying competition and slower volume-led growth in recent years, he said.

TN junks plan for ₹27,400-crore Parandur airport

TE Raja Simhan
Chennai

Villagers in Ekanapuram, about 70 km west of Chennai, are rejoicing after the Tamil Nadu government dropped the proposed ₹27,400-crore greenfield airport project at Parandur.

Chief Minister C Joseph Vijay on Monday confirmed that the project initiated by the previous government had been abandoned. The government is now exploring alternative sites for Chennai's second airport.

Read more p3

TCS to buy Porsche arm for €320 million

Vallari Sanzgiri
Mumbai

Tata Consultancy Services (TCS) on Monday announced a €320 million (\$373 million) acquisition deal with Germany-based Porsche AG for its automotive and industrial-consulting arm. The move will anchor a five-year partnership deal between the two companies, worth €1.25 billion.

Details p2

Concerns persist over availability of Sun Pharma eye drops even after recall

PT Jyothi Datta
Mumbai

Sun Pharmaceutical's recent voluntary withdrawal of 11 eye drops has raised concerns over the implementation and enforcement of product recalls, with some retailers and regulatory officials saying they were unaware of the recall.

Sun initiated the withdrawal in mid-July as a “precautionary measure”, according to a letter to partners. A month later, *businessline* was able to procure two of the recalled products from local chemists. The company has not issued a public alert to consumers.

Drug regulatory experts flagged “patchy” implementation and enforcement of recalls, and called for a real-time system to communicate product withdrawals across the supply chain and to consumers.

Udaya Bhaskar of the All India Drugs Control Officers' Confederation said regulators should establish why a product is withdrawn and ensure that it is recalled from end-users.

The brands voluntarily withdrawn included Depo-

pred 2ML, Brinolar (BKC Free), Brinzotim Eye Drops SML BKC Free, Lotepred 5ML and Nepalact OD Eye Drops 3ML. In June, ophthalmologists cautioned against certain batches of Predmet eye drops following “microbiological findings”. *businessline* has sought the Health Ministry's response on whether a public alert was issued; a response is awaited.

Sun Pharma told this correspondent, “We have voluntarily withdrawn some ophthalmic products and informed the Central and State regulatory authority. We are working closely with healthcare professionals, hospitals and authorities concerned and have taken all necessary steps in accordance with applicable regulatory requirements.”

REAL TIME RECALL

Rishi Agrawal, Co-founder and CEO of TeamLease RegTech, said, “The flow of information ... and the flow of enforcement is very fragmented and poor.”

Drug companies and regulators should also be able to communicate recalls across the system and directly to end-users, including through phone messages, he said.

RENAULT DUSTER ADVENTURE

7 year warranty

Renault Duster range starts at 10.49L*
5-star safety rating by Bharat NCAP



electric panoramic sunroof



electric powered tailgate



25.65cm openR link multimedia screen

*Renault Duster now comes with a maximum warranty of up to 7 years or 150 000 kms, whichever is earlier, under the Renault Forever program. The price mentioned in this advertisement is the ex-showroom price for the base variant. The features mentioned in this advertisement may vary depending on the model/variant of the car. 5-star rating awarded by Bharat NCAP (India's independent vehicle safety assessment program) is based on crash tests and safety evaluations. Images shown are for representation purpose only. Actual vehicle, features, and colours may vary. For detailed terms and conditions, please visit www.renault.co.in.

Renault recommends Castrol

SHOWROOMS: TAMIL NADU: CHENNAI: RENAULT AMBATTUR Ph: 9103781804, RENAULT AVADI Ph: 8130309672, RENAULT CHROMPET Ph: 9311700662, RENAULT KATTUPAKKAM Ph: 8527234359, RENAULT MOUNT ROAD Ph: 7428881087, RENAULT OMR Ph: 8527240381, RENAULT KILPAUK Ph: 8448989109, RENAULT GUDUVANCHERY Ph: 9289631446, RENAULT KANCHIPURAM Ph: 7428892736. **ANDAMAN & NICOBAR ISLANDS:** RENAULT PORT BLAIR Ph: 8527240556.

This zero-sum game acts as a wealth transfer to foreign traders, draining forex reserves at a time when the highest offices in the country are proactively urging citizens to limit gold and fuel consumption. The solution perhaps lies in taking stronger steps on F&O speculation. A targeted increase in the Securities Transaction Tax (STT) only on options trading is perhaps worth looking at. While the “ideal” ratio of F&Os to cash is up for debate, a system where India leads the world by such a massive margin needs to be dismantled. Simultaneously, regulators should introduce policies to deepen the over-the-counter (OTC) derivatives market, giving institutions a wholesale venue to trade amongst themselves and away from retail exchanges. True success on this front will not be marked by regulatory warnings alone. The data should tell a different story, sooner than later.



Analysis of granular data of the closing auction session shows that volatility has subsided and there is no impact on the overall trading volumes due to the move. Volumes in the CAS could, however, continue to be muted since trading activity will be low in the closing session. SEBI must continue with this initiative, while watching out for wrongful activity.

The problem with VWAP is that it is an average price and does not represent a price at which actual transactions have been executed. Many passive fund managers have apparently complained to SEBI that the difference between the price at which transactions happen in the last 30 minutes and the VWAP, gives rise to tracking error when they buy stocks to emulate an index. VWAP was

Market participants have been quite wary about the closing auction session, preferring to close all the trades before 3.15 pm. This is borne by the fact that the average traded value in the NSE in

because, here, the closing price is chosen from the orders placed in the session

Crop-specific yield assessment should be intensified in rain-fed districts. Tur, soybean and maize deserve particular attention

A moderate national rainfall deficit need not generate a major price shock if

Though the relationship between El Niño and the Indian monsoon is complex, it does strengthen the case for preparing for rainfall variability during the remainder of the season.

First, crop-specific yield assessment should be intensified in vulnerable



Third, global supply chains need to be treated as part of India's food-security infrastructure. Geopolitical tensions, shipping disruptions and bottlenecks can make an otherwise manageable domestic production shortfall more difficult to absorb. Port capacity, shipping

The broader lesson is that the economic impact of a weak monsoon depends less on the headline rainfall deficit than on how effectively the economy absorbs it. India cannot control the monsoon or El Niño. It can, however, improve crop intelligence, act early on imports and stocks, strengthen logistics and protect vulnerable households.

The objective should be straightforward: identify a potential supply shortfall before it becomes a price shock.

The writer is with NCAER, New Delhi. Views expressed are personal

autonomy'. It is sad that this Bill was also passed without much discussion. The Tribunal Reforms Bill sought to streamline India's tribunal system by abolishing certain appellate bodies and transferring their work to High Courts or other judicial forums. It could reduce administrative duplication, simplify the justice-delivery structure, and bring greater consistency to appeals. However, transferring cases to already overburdened High Courts may delay justice. India needs adequately staffed, specialised tribunals with transparent

To miss the 'Colour of healthcare funding', (August 24), is feigning convenient colour blindness. The spiralling of healthcare costs is in part attributable to the legitimate profit motive of private enterprise, which unfortunately comes at the cost of hapless patients. Scientific advancements have improved treatment, but private investment will inevitably have a profit motive. It is imperative for the government to step up spending on

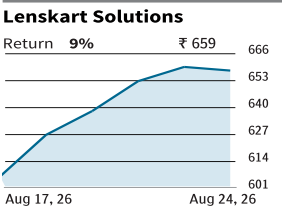
'A taste of Mundhe' (August, 24) captures the spirit of citizens. They are indeed rejoicing at the drive of the State FDA in cleaning up the eateries business including high end establishments. But one wonders what was happening before he took charge. What was the department doing all these years? It cannot be that the businesses behaved like angels then and have suddenly changed track

Apropos, 'India's Thatcher moments', (August 24). In any equation, the resultant output depends upon its variables, which require periodic recalibration for improved outcomes. Electoral politics follows the same principle: parties must modify

N Sadhasiva Reddy
Bengaluru

QUICKLY.

SoftBank pares 2.6% stake in Lenskart for ₹2,888 cr



New Delhi: The SoftBank Group has again trimmed its holding in Lenskart Solutions, selling nearly a 2.6 per cent stake in the eyewear retailer for ₹2,888 crore in the open market on Monday. In June, SoftBank sold a 3.25 per cent stake in Lenskart for ₹2,873 crore. In the latest transaction, a SoftBank arm offloaded 4.5 crore shares in 22 tranches at an average price of ₹641.75. Buyers included National Pension System Trust and MFS managed by SBI, Edelweiss, Nippon India, Franklin Templeton, HDFC, HSBC, ICICI Prudential, Motilal Oswal and Sundaram, ICICI Prudential Life, Societe Generale, Goldman Sachs, Morgan Stanley and Vanguard. **PM**

Invt investor base rises 17% in June quarter

Mumbai: The investor base of Infrastructure Investment Trusts (InvIT) rose 17 per cent sequentially to 6.53 lakh in the June quarter, while distributions to unit holders increased 15 per cent year-on-year. According to data released by the Bharat InvITs Association (BIA), distributions stood at ₹5,923 crore in the first quarter of FY27, compared with ₹5,153 crore in the year-earlier period. Cumulative distributions since inception crossed ₹97,000 crore. NS Venkatesh, CEO, BIA, said the growth in distributions reflected the sector's ability to deliver consistent cash flows and create long-term value for unit holders. The sector's AUM rose to ₹7.3 lakh crore, up 13.7 per cent from ₹6.42 lakh crore a year earlier. **OUR BUREAU**

Tempsens' ₹650-cr IPO gets bids for ₹84,000 cr, subscribed 184x

HEAVY DEMAND. Issue attracts interest across the board as grey market price soars

Anupama Ghosh Mumbai

The ₹650-crore initial public offering of Tempsens Instruments (India) Ltd, a thermal engineering and specialised cable manufacturer, received bids worth ₹83,834 crore with all categories of investors pouring in money. The issue received bids for 279.44 crore shares against 1.518 crore crore shares on offer, resulting in subscription of 184.07 times. According to market participants, the strong interest in the IPO was largely driven by the grey market premium it commanded. Some estimates suggested that the stock is currently quoting at nearly twice its IPO price. The company came out with an IPO at a price band of

Investor inflows

	No of times
QIBs	302.88
Non-institutions	314.44
Retail investors	60.69
Employee portion	124.95
Total	184.07

₹285-300. Non-Institutional Investors (NIIs) led the demand at 314.44 times subscription, with the over ₹10 lakh category (BHNI) clocking 331.34 times and the ₹2-10 lakh category (SHNI) 280.66 times. Qualified Institutional Buyers (QIBs) subscribed 302.88 times, and the retail investors' portion was subscribed 60.69 times. The employee reservation portion was subscribed



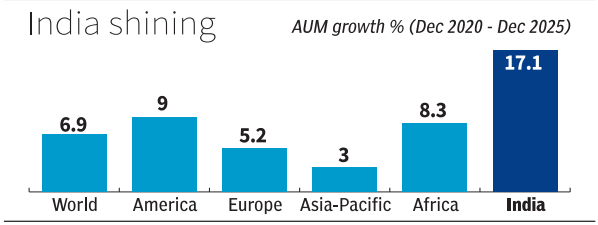
124.95 times, the highest surpassing ideaForge Technology (96.65 times) and Shiprocket 55.65 times.

TOUGH ALLOTMENT Based on the final subscription figures, the chance of getting allotment is very difficult. For instance, only one out of every 66 retail applicants is likely to get allotment of 50 shares, while one out of about 260 SHNI applicants may get 700 shares, and two

Indian MFs register fastest growth globally in 5 years

Our Bureau Mumbai

The Indian mutual funds industry registered the fastest asset under management growth globally in the last five years on the back of steady inflows and bullish equity markets. The net AUM of the domestic MF industry was up 17 per cent between December 2020 and December 2025, while globally MFs recorded a growth of 7 per cent, according to the Factbook 2026 'Resilient run' released by AMFI and Crisil.



per cent, signalling a durable rise in its relevance within the global asset management landscape, the report said. Sundeeep Sikka, Chairman, Association of Mutual Funds in India, said many mature markets are witnessing slower growth and an increasing shift towards lower-cost investment products. In contrast, India continues to stand out as a bright spot in the global asset man-

agement landscape, he added. The rising formalisation of household finance, wider SIP-led retail participation, growing awareness, digital access and regulatory credibility have collectively expanded the industry's asset-gathering capacity beyond the cyclical market support, the report said. The number of unique MF investors increased from 23

crore in March 2021 to 6.1 crore in March 2026, a growth of nearly 2.7 times. This growth indicates that the industry's expansion is increasingly being supported by wider household participation, rather than only by market appreciation or higher investments from existing investors. Venkat Nageswar Chalasani, Chief Executive, AMFI, said even as major economies faced high inflation, rising interest rates and geopolitical tensions, India stood out as a beacon of stability and growth. "Instead of slowing down, India's domestic capital markets showed remarkable maturity, absorbing global shocks and keeping the momentum strong," he added.

Lalithaa Jewellery glitters on day 1; Horizon Ind ends below IPO price

Our Bureau Bengaluru

Shares of Lalithaa Jewellery Mart on Monday made a strong debut on the stock exchanges, listing at ₹265, a 32 per cent premium over the IPO price of ₹201 even as the Blackstone-backed Horizon Industrial Parks witnessed a muted start. Lalithaa Jewellery ended at ₹248.44 on the NSE with a 24 per cent gain over the IPO price. Meanwhile, Horizon Industrial had a dull day, closing with over 3 per cent loss at ₹58.16 and ₹57.95 on the NSE and the BSE respectively, against the IPO price of ₹60 after opening flat. According to Shivani Nyati, Head of Wealth, Swastika Investmart, Lalithaa Jewellery remains attractively valued compared with organised peers such as Kalyan Jewellers and Titan, while its ROE of over 41 per cent indicates strong capital efficiency. However, negative operat-



BRIGHT START. Radha Kirthivasan (fifth from left), Head-Issuer Relations & Corporate Sales, BSE, with officials and family members of Lalithaa Jewellery Mart at the listing ceremony

ing cash flow of around ₹397.7 crore in FY26, the ₹1,066 crore GST dispute and promoter-related concerns remain key risks, she said. On Horizon Industrial Parks, Nyati said the muted debut does not alter the long-term positive outlook. She highlighted the company's 93.56 per cent committed occupancy across 118 enterprise tenants and the fact that 54.05 per cent of leased space is occupied by Fortune 500 companies.

IPO DETAILS The initial public offering of

Lalithaa Jewellery Mart received 62.97 times subscription overall while Horizon Industrial Parks' was subscribed 1.45 times. Lalithaa Jewellery's IPO, which came out with a price band of ₹190-201 a share, comprised a fresh issue of up to ₹1,200 crore and an OFS of up to ₹500 crore. Proceeds from the fresh issue will primarily fund new stores. On the other hand, the IPO of Horizon Industrial was entirely a fresh issue. It proposes to use the IPO proceeds primarily to repay borrowings.

Shanti Inorganics to raise ₹47 cr via NSE Emerge IPO

Our Bureau Mumbai

Shanti Inorganics, a manufacturer and supplier of sulphur-based inorganic chemicals, plans to raise ₹47 crore through an initial public offering on NSE Emerge. The company will issue 56.91 lakh shares in the price band of ₹79-83. The IPO opens for subscription on August 31. The net proceeds from the IPO will be used for part funding the capex for setting up a manufacturing facility at Ahmedabad. Avnish Manojkumar Patel, Joint Managing Director, Shanti Inorganics, said over the years, the company had strengthened its manufacturing capabilities and broadened product portfolio to include ammonium bisulphite, sodium bisulphite, sodium metabisulphite and sodium sulphite.

Ketan Parekh's plea to quiz Capital Group traders dismissed

Akshata Gorde Mumbai

The Securities Appellate Tribunal (SAT) has dismissed an appeal by Ketan Parekh challenging the Securities and Exchange Board of India's (SEBI) refusal to allow him to cross-examine two Capital Group traders in a front-running case. The tribunal said Parekh could raise concerns over any material allegedly relied upon by SEBI while challenging the regulator's final order in the matter. "Once the matter is reserved, the only right that remains for the appellant is to challenge the final order," Justice PS Dinesh Kumar, presiding officer of SAT, said on Monday. He can now only challenge SEBI's final order. The case follows SEBI's January 2025 interim order against Parekh and Singa-

pore-based trader Rohit Salgaocar over the alleged front-running of trades of Capital Group, a large US-based foreign portfolio investor. The regulator had ordered disgorgement of ₹65.77 crore in alleged unlawful gains. **ADVANCE INFO** SEBI alleged that Salgaocar had access to information on the fund's trades in advance and communicated the information to Parekh, who allegedly used various trading accounts and associates in Kolkata to build positions before the fund executed its trades. In November 2025, SAT allowed Salgaocar to cross-examine Parekh and directed SEBI to facilitate the process. Parekh was previously barred from the securities market for 14 years over his role in the 2000 stock market scam.

BROKER'S CALL.

Emkay Global

URBAN COMPANY (BUY) Target: ₹190 CMP: ₹168.50 We initiate coverage on Urban Company with BUY and DCF-based SOTP TP of ₹190. Urban Company is the leader of India's online home services market, whose large TAM and highly unorganised nature provide the company with a long growth runway. Increasing demand density in micro-markets is driving consumer satisfaction as well as partner wages, thereby reinforcing the flywheel. This has led to accelerating growth, and we build in 19.8 per cent FY26-29E net transaction value (NTV) CAGR for India consumer services, ex-InstaHelp (ICS). With high operating leverage, we build in 47.4 per cent adjusted EBITDA CAGR over FY26-29E for ICS. While the street is concerned about Urban Company's InstaHelp foray given the upfront cash burn, we believe this is the right playbook to improve platform stickiness and drive cross-sell. Urban Company has the opportunity to capture a large TAM and increase frequency of platform use, which should create a sticky business. Considering the company is incubating InstaHelp and Native, and international business profitability is suboptimal, we expect Urban Company to turn profitable only in FY30. The stock trades at 10.4x/8.3x FY28E/FY29E revenue. **Key risks:** Intense competition in the InstaHelp segment; legal or regulatory changes for service professionals/gig workers; litigation risks; and service partner availability and cost inflation.

JM Financial

CONCOR (ADD) Target: ₹540 CMP: ₹517 Container Corporation's (Concor) first long haul double stack container movement from JNPT to Vadodara (422 kms) took place on August 21 for a load of 360 TEUs, and is a key milestone for the company in our view. It demonstrates that the WDFC (Western Dedicated Freight Corridor) is now operational. Moreover, it also shows that longer double stacking is not just a theoretical possibility, but a practical reality now. Increased long haul double stack has the potential to reduce congestion and lead to better asset utilisation (current single stack operations are 90TEUs), which could improve rail competitiveness against roads. It also cuts down the number of train moves for the same load, reducing track congestion and cutting time o deliveries. The current West Asia crisis has caused inflation in truck freight rates (led by diesel price increases), which, in addition to WDFC operations, could lead to some rail container volume uptick post monsoon (Q3FY27). We value the CCRI's core business using a DCF methodology, yielding a TP of ₹540, and maintain Add. We believe the risk-reward is fairly justified. The WDFC connection and near-term rail modal share gains due to higher truck freights (driven in part by rising diesel prices) could support a rise in share prices. However, at that stage, the risk-reward may again turn adverse as was the case before the stock's underperformance hitherto.

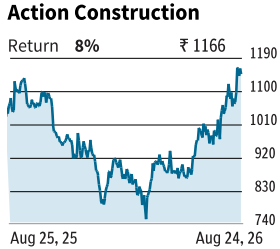
businessline is not responsible for the recommendations sourced from third party brokerages. Reports may be sent to: **blmarketwatch@gmail.com**

TODAY'S PICK.

Action Construction (₹1,166.20): BUY

Gurumurthy K bl. research bureau

The short-term outlook is bullish for Action Construction Equipment. The stock is in a good uptrend since April. Within that, the price has been in consolidation over the last few days. Immediate support for the stock is at ₹1,150. Below that ₹1,110, the 21-Day Moving Average (DMA), is the next important support. We expect the stock to resume its uptrend in the coming days. That leg of rise could take the share price higher to ₹1,385 in a month or two. Traders can buy Action Construction Equipment shares now at ₹1,166. Accumulate on dips at ₹1,155. Keep the



stop-loss at ₹1,060. Trail the stop-loss up to ₹1,195 as soon as the stock goes up to ₹1,240. Revise the stop-loss higher to ₹1,245 and ₹1,310 when the price touches ₹1,280 and ₹1,340 respectively. Exit the long positions at ₹1,365.

Note: The recommendations are based on technical analysis. There is a risk of loss in trading

Day trading guide

24188 » Nifty 50 Futures					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
24150	24080	24220	24300	Go short only below 24150. Keep the stop-loss at 24170	
₹727 » HDFC Bank					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
724	715	732	737	Go short only below 724. Stop-loss can be placed at 726	
₹1129 » Infosys					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
1115	1090	1145	1165	Go long on a bounce from 1115 with a stop-loss at 1105	
₹268 » ITC					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
266	264	270	273	Take fresh longs above 270. Keep the stop-loss at 269	
₹236 » ONGC					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
235	233	237	240	Can go either way. Avoid trading this stock for now	
₹1304 » Reliance Ind.					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
1300	1285	1330	1350	Take fresh long position now with a stop-loss at 1295	
₹1036 » SBI					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
1025	1010	1045	1060	Go short only below 1025. Keep the stop-loss at 1030	
₹2281 » TCS					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
2265	2235	2300	2325	Go short on a break below 2265. Keep the stop-loss at 2275	

S1, S2: Support 1 & 2; R1, R2: Resistance 1 & 2.

SEBI launches IT Resilience Index for market infrastructure institutions

Our Bureau Mumbai

The Securities and Exchange Board of India has introduced an IT Resilience Index (ITRI) to assess the functioning and resilience of information technology systems of market infrastructure institutions (MIIs), including stock exchanges, depositories and clearing corporations.

Under the framework, the ITRI will be computed using a uniform set of nine parameters, each carrying specific weightage to ensure comparability across MIIs. Availability and security will carry the highest weightage of 20 per cent each, followed by integrity, governance, reliability and monitoring, business continuity, and modularity and flexibility at 10 per cent each. Scalability and other aspects, including incident handling, will account for the remaining 5 per cent each. The move is aimed at strengthening the oversight of the resilience of IT systems and identifying emerging weaknesses at an early stage, so that timely corrective measures can be taken. MIIs will also develop an early warning system (EWS) to detect any deterioration in ITRI parameters that could potentially lead to performance issues, system slowness or other disruptions, and take remedial measures. **FRAMEWORK READY** The beta version of the ITRI framework has already been implemented. It will be operationalised along with the EWS and real-time monitoring of service delivery by February 28 next. The first ITRI computation under the framework will cover the half-year ended March 31, 2027. MIIs



will compute the index on a half-yearly basis within 60 days of the end of each half-year and submit a comparative analysis of two consecutive half-years. The Industry Standards Forum will formulate baseline parameters, acceptable threshold scores and standard operating procedures (SOPs) for calculating the ITRI, along with an objective, system-driven scoring methodology. MIIs will further formulate SOPs to monitor system availability and the continuity of service delivery to market participants and flag any disruption or deviation.

CYBER PORTAL

Separately, the regulator has aligned its Incident Reporting Portal with the Format for Incident Reporting Exchange (FIRE) framework developed by the Financial Stability Board (FSB) in order to streamline the reporting of cyber incidents. FIRE enables structured incident reporting by defining common information fields, standardised definitions and consistent classification of incident attributes, promoting harmonisation across sectors or jurisdictions. "The portal will facilitate reporting of incidents in stages to reflect the incident life cycle from initial reporting to intermediate updates and final closure, while acknowledging that certain information may not be available at the time of initial reporting," it said.

Nifty 50 Movers ▼ 32.95 pts.				
	Close(%)	Pts	PE	WN(%)
Hindalco	10658.50	7.75	14.50	1.38
Infosys	11300.00	6.90	15.12	3.58
HDFC Bank	729.00	6.86	13.61	10.07
JSW Steel	1327.00	6.83	11.59	1.12
Tata Steel	186.30	5.96	20.65	1.39
Sun Pharma	1322.00	4.49	20.58	1.26
HCL Tech	2020.00	2.91	45.45	1.62
Hind Unilever	11800.00	2.42	28.55	1.18
Dr Reddys Lab	1190.00	2.04	31.20	0.65
TataConsumerProduct	2998.60	1.92	64.03	0.62
Sun Pharma	1910.00	1.76	37.82	1.82
Maruti Suzuki	13620.00	1.57	29.87	1.69
Eicher Motors	8047.00	1.11	38.27	1.00
Coal India	406.90	0.89	8.04	0.88
Cipla	1437.90	0.70	34.62	0.73
ITC	269.70	0.63	16.74	2.35
M&M	3414.10	0.37	20.97	2.75
Wipro	181.31	0.31	13.52	0.44
IntiglobeAvi	5115.00	0.25	0.00	1.04
Apollo Hosp	8702.00	0.20	57.61	0.81
ONGC	236.55	0.13	6.64	0.83
Adani Enter	2998.60	0.10	51.92	0.78
Asian Paints	268.90	0.02	52.37	1.00
Tech Mahindra	1584.00	0.00	30.07	0.91
HDFC Life	552.95	-0.43	60.41	0.54
NTPC	339.50	-0.52	11.62	1.45
Titan	5079.00	-0.64	78.28	1.89
L&T	4090.00	-0.77	28.67	4.32
NestleIndia	1471.30	-0.91	74.44	0.95
PowerGrid Corp	271.40	-0.99	15.88	1.11
Eternal Ltd.	327.15	-1.34	729.13	2.13
Trent Ltd.	2905.00	-1.38	85.36	0.87
Jio Financial Services Ltd.	242.00	-1.43	77.33	0.72
Nax Healthcare	990.50	-1.54	66.15	0.67
Tata Motors PV	314.40	-1.60	0.00	0.59
Grasim Ind	3288.00	-1.65	19.66	1.12
UltraTech Cement	11504.00	-1.71	39.55	1.23
Kotak Bank	401.45	-2.17	19.67	2.67
SBI Life	1761.80	-3.05	67.95	0.71
Shriram Finance Ltd.	1119.00	-3.27	23.26	1.41
Bajaj Finserv	2001.70	-3.90	15.52	1.05
Bharat Elec	409.00	-3.91	48.63	1.32
TCS	2284.10	-3.99	16.51	2.10
Adani Ports	1672.10	-4.50	29.36	1.11
Axis Bank	1262.10	-6.15	11.76	3.20
Bharti Airtel	1935.00	-7.21	32.53	1.37
ICI Bank	1415.00	-7.83	16.99	9.15
State Bank	1039.50	-8.31	10.70	3.88
Reliance Ind	1309.80	-9.15	20.10	7.98
Bajaj Finance	1077.00	-10.54	32.48	2.60

Pts: Impact on index movement

Nifty Next 50 Movers

▲ 30.30 pts.

	Close(%)	Pts	PE	WN(%)
Muthootfin	3209.00	58.28	11.24	1.35
Siemens	4114.00	49.84	100.85	1.43
Cummins India	5190.00	52.39	60.78	2.75
Indian Oilcorp	138.50	28.23	5.47	2.03
Jindal Steel	1149.00	22.82	43.27	1.67
Cg Power & Ind Sol	877.50	20.92	111.62	2.36
Dif	689.00	20.32	38.36	1.74
AvenueSuper	3940.00	15.92	84.05	2.49
Tata Motors Cv	475.05	15.17	41.78	3.90
Cal India	117.75	13.72	11.76	1.84
MacroTech Developers	1258.40	13.22	30.45	1.37
Siemens Energy India	3485.70	12.88	83.42	1.21
Hindus Zinc	604.00	12.72	14.95	1.14
Adani Energy Solutions	1555.10	12.60	60.45	2.01
Abb India	7504.00	12.20	102.25	1.55
Litimindree	4525.70	10.23	25.83	1.65
Pidlifind	1660.00	9.91	63.13	2.02
Bpcl	311.90	5.20	7.90	2.48
Hdfc Amc	2618.00	4.74	38.07	2.10
Rural Elec	327.90	4.54	5.38	1.61
Power Finance	364.00	4.23	3.57	2.08
Solar Industries	19925.00	1.77	87.94	1.91
Union Bank	183.60	0.84	6.79	1.28
United Spirits	1555.00	-0.86	67.04	1.80
Tata Capital	364.45	-0.88	28.24	0.72
Indian Railway Finance Corp	85.99	-2.40	15.63	0.68
Bosch	48100.00	-2.52	60.03	1.64
Mazagon Dock	2540.00	-2.65	35.90	0.72
Indian Hotels Co.	728.90	-2.81	44.46	2.51
Tata Power	371.50	-3.88	22.71	2.46
Torrent Pharma	4886.50	-4.26	86.21	2.81
Godrej Consumer	928.90	-4.79	49.67	1.47
Samvardhoseinternational	169.00	-4.88	39.16	2.93
Hyundai Motor India	220.00	-4.89	36.28	1.24
Punjab Nat Bank	115.96	-6.91	6.02	1.57
Varun Beverages	428.00	-8.34	42.46	2.30
Vedanta	277.00	-9.86	6.49	1.84
Shree Cement	24020.00	-10.11	52.97	1.26
Amulja Cements	408.75	-10.42	19.58	1.00
AdaniGreenenergy	1308.00	-11.69	100.40	1.72
Infraesciences	119.00	-11.78	24.18	0.98
Tyres Moto Corp	4363.50	-18.09	57.57	4.02
Britannia Ind	5311.00	-18.49	49.01	2.46
Cholamandamini&Fin	1846.70	-20.37	27.37	3.14
Adani Power	203.70	-20.70	27.03	3.32
Bajaj Holdings	11120.00	-25.16	13.76	1.89
India Cements	119.00	-25.98	5.82	1.69
Coal of Orissa	241.50	-29.65	6.79	1.76
Divis Lab	8496.00	-37.30	77.11	4.24
Industrialaeronautics	4590.00	-51.82	35.20	3.65

QUICKLY.

Tata Capital signs MoU with Japan's Resona Bank



Mumbai: Tata Capital Ltd (TCL) signed an MoU with Japan's Resona Bank on Monday to explore opportunities for business matching and introduction through the former's network. The collaboration follows Resona Bank's \$20 million commitment as a limited partner in Tata Capital Growth Fund III LP, which invests in Tata Capital Growth Fund III, a SEBI-registered category II AIF managed by TCL. "Both companies said the primary objective of the collaboration is to leverage their respective strengths in the Indian market," said TCL. **OUR BUREAU**

Anirudh Ravichander joins Ironhill as investor

Bengaluru: Ironhill, formed through the merger of Ironhill India with Ironhill US, has announced that Indian composer Anirudh Ravichander has joined the company as an investor for an undisclosed amount. The investment in Ironhill, made through his venture Albuquerque Records, marks Anirudh's second foray into the global hospitality and F&B sector after Loka Loka Tequila. Anirudh's investment follows the recently announced formation of Ironhill as a single international platform through a merger that brings together Ironhill India's growth capital, operational scale and consumer insight with Ironhill US' craft brewing legacy and hospitality heritage. The group currently operates multiple venues across India and the US, with active expansion into new international markets planned through 2026 and 2027. **OUR BUREAU**

Govt appoints Syed Akbaruddin, JK Sinha and Annie George as Directors on RBI Central Board

Our Bureau

Mumbai

The Central government has appointed Janmejaya Kumar Sinha, Syed Akbaruddin and Annie George Mathew as part-time, non-official Directors on the Central Board of the Reserve Bank of India for four years with effect from August 24, or until further orders, whichever is earlier.

Sinha is the Chairman for India and member of the Boston Consulting Group's Henderson Institute Innovation Sounding Board, which is dedicated to supporting, inspiring and guiding upstream innovation at BCG. Prior to joining BCG in 1998, he worked with the RBI.

Akbaruddin, an Indian Foreign Service officer of the

India plans first tokenised bond issue next month

Reuters

Mumbai

India will launch tokenised corporate bonds next month as it tests the use of blockchain technology to enable instant settlement of bond transactions, three sources with direct knowledge of the matter said on Monday.

The notes, to be issued for the first time by state-owned power financier REC, would place India alongside markets such as Europe and Hong Kong in using the technology for issuance and settlement.

Tokenised bonds are securities whose ownership, issuance, trading and settlement are recorded digitally on a blockchain or distributed ledger, allowing transactions to be completed almost instantly. Markets regulator SEBI and the Reserve Bank of India are working together to push the technology.

Positive investments in gold ETFs continue for fifth week in a row

OPPORTUNE TIME. US and UK lead the trend as investors find the current price of over \$4,600/ounce attractive

Subramani Ra Mancombu

Chennai

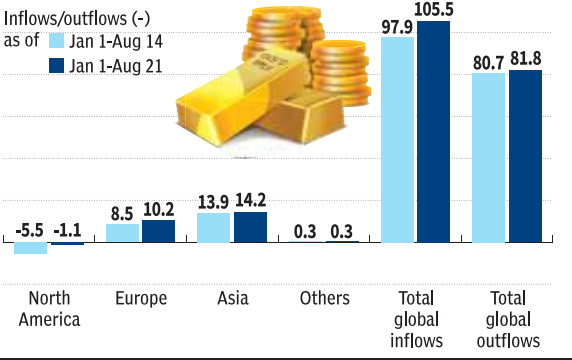
Inflows into physically backed gold exchange traded funds (ETFs) continued to be positive for the fifth consecutive week as investors found the price of the yellow metal above \$4,600 an ounce attractive.

Data from the World Gold Council (WGC) showed that the US and the UK led the investments in gold ETFs last week. Investments in the week ending August 21 were \$7.56 billion, while exits were to the tune of \$1.18 billion, leaving inflows net positive at \$6.38 billion.

Colin Shah, MD of Kama Jewelry, said a sharp rally witnessed over the past fortnight in gold underscored the metal's enduring appeal as a haven asset amid evolving global macroeconomic cues.

It reflects the catapult effect that has held back the

Sustaining the glitter



Source: WGC

bull run in the yellow metal price. Darshan Desai, CEO, Aspect Bullion & Refinery, said that the bullion market was witnessing strong momentum. Softer dollar expectations, haven demand and global interest rate cues continued to support precious metals.

UP 15% IN A MONTH Gold, which has gained

nearly 15 per cent in the past month and 6 per cent in the past week, traded at \$4,676 an ounce on Monday at 1845 hours IST.

Investments in gold ETFs began to rise after the yellow metal's rise began after hovering near \$4,000 for quite some time.

Last week, inflows in the US were \$4.37 billion, while in the UK, they were \$1.07

The fact that the company has gone into liquidation does not erase the completed offence, said a Delhi court

Accordingly, the court found both accused — the company (through the official liquidator) and its Managing Director Mahadom Bava — guilty of the offences punishable under the Income Tax Act, 1961, for FY10. Announcing the penalty and sentence, the court said that a company being a

billion. The French invested \$443 million, the Chinese \$280 million and the Germans \$130 million.

Data on India were unavailable. Overall, North American investments were \$4.37 billion, European \$1.7 billion and Asians \$293 million.

YEAR-TO-DATE INFLOWS Year-to-date net investments increased to \$23.611 billion, with total inflows being \$105.45 billion and outflows \$81.83 billion. Investments in the US continued to be negative at \$816 million, but China led the inflows at \$7.39 billion.

Investments in the UK in gold ETFs increased to \$6.16 billion, while Indian investments have almost touched \$4 billion. The Swiss also had investments to the tune of \$2.63 billion.

Other countries that witnessed significant inflows were Germany (\$990 million), the Hong Kong Special

Administrative Region (\$964.5 million), Japan (\$844.8 million) and South Korea (\$697.5 million). Canada is another country where net inflows were negative at \$281.6 million.

Gold ETFs have been zig-zagging after the Iran war broke out on February 28. Fears of inflation, a rise in bond yields, hike in US Fed rates and consumers shifting to crude oil counters from gold weighed on the yellow metal until a fortnight ago.

WHY THE GAIN

However, since then, the precious metal has gained on a subdued dollar, which has boosted the appeal of bullion. The US' surprise decision to double long-term bond buybacks has driven gold up on lower yields and the dollar's weakening.

Since hitting a record high of \$5,608 an ounce on January 29, the precious metal has dropped by over 17 per cent to date.

juristic person cannot undergo imprisonment.

"The plea that the company presently has no funds can be relevant to the quantum of fine, but it does not warrant an order that the company be sentenced without any fine at all. Such an approach would reduce a serious statutory conviction of a corporate offender to a declaration without penal consequence," it said. At the same time, the court must account for the fact that the company is in liquidation and is represented by the official liquidator.

IMPOSES PENALTY After going through all the

submissions and arguments made, the court ordered the company to pay a fine of ₹10 lakh for the offence.

The fine shall be payable by the official liquidator from the assets/funds of the company. In the event that no realisable assets are available, the fine shall be recoverable in accordance with law, and shall not be enforced through impermissible coercive measures against the official liquidator personally.

At the same time, the MD was awarded a sentence to undergo rigorous imprisonment for a period of 1 year and 10 months, with a fine of ₹10 lakh.

COFFEE DAY
Brewing new possibilities.

COFFEE DAY ENTERPRISES LTD.
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Website: www.coffeedaygroup.com; E: Investors@coffeedaygroup.com
Corporate Identification Number: L55101KA2008PLC046866

NOTICE OF THE 18TH AGM, REMOTE E VOTING INFORMATION AND RECORD DATE

The 18th Annual General Meeting (AGM) of the Coffee Day Enterprises Limited (the Company) will be held on Monday, 21st September 2026 at 11:00 A.M.(IST) through video conferencing (VC) or other audio-visual means (OAVM) to transact the Ordinary Businesses as set out in the Notice of AGM ("Notice"), without the presence of the members at a common venue (DEEMED TO BE HELD AT THE REGISTERED OFFICE OF THE COMPANY).

The AGM will be convened in accordance with the section 108 of the Companies Act, 2013, read with Rule 20 of the Companies (Management and Administration) Rules, 2014, Regulation 44 of the Securities and Exchange Board of India ("SEBI") (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 and any other applicable provisions along with the General circular No. 03/2025 dated September 22, 2025, issued by the Ministry of Corporate Affairs (MCA) and circular issued by SEBI vide circular no. SEBI/HO/CFD/CFDPoD-2/P/CIR/2024/133 dated October 3, 2024 ("SEBI Circular") and other applicable circulars and notifications issued (including any statutory modifications or re-enactment thereof for the time being in force and as amended from time to time, companies are allowed to hold AGM through Video Conferencing (VC) or other audio-visual means (OAVM), without the physical presence of members at a common venue. In compliance with the said Circulars, AGM shall be conducted through VC / OAVM. The registered office of the company shall be the deemed venue of the 18th AGM.

The Notice of the 18th AGM and the Annual Report for FY 2025-26 of the Company have been sent, through electronic mode to all the Members whose email IDs are registered with the Company/Depository Participant(s). The Notice and the Annual Report are also available on the Company's website at www.coffeedaygroup.com and on the website of the stock exchange(s) where the shares of the Company are listed, namely the BSE Limited at www.bseindia.com and the National Stock Exchange of India Limited at www.nseindia.com, and on the website of the National Securities Depository Limited ("NSDL") at <https://www.evoting.nsdl.com/>.

The Company has completed the dispatch of the Notice along with the Annual Report on Monday, August 24th, 2026, through electronic mode. The requirements of sending physical copy of the Notice of the 18th AGM and Annual Report to the Members have been dispensed with vide the aforementioned circulars.

Members holding shares in dematerialized form are requested to get their email address registered with the concerned depositories. Members holding shares in physical form are requested to furnish their email address and mobile number with the Company's Registrar & Share Transfer Agent, MUGF Intime India Pvt. Ltd, at mt.helpdesk@linkintime.co.in with a copy to the Company investors@coffeedaygroup.com to get their email address registered. Members are requested to quote their DP ID & Client ID / Folio No., in case shares are held in dematerialized / physical form, as the case may be, in all correspondence with the Registrar and Share Transfer Agent and/or the Company.

Pursuant to the requirements under the aforementioned Act, Rules, Regulations and the circulars, the items of business to be transacted at the AGM shall be transacted through electronic means. The Members (holding shares both in physical and in electronic form) are provided with the facility to cast their votes on all resolutions set forth in the Notice of AGM, through remote e-voting, prior to the date of the AGM and e-voting during the AGM for those Members who could not cast their votes earlier through remote e-voting. The Company has engaged the National Securities Depository Limited (NSDL) for facilitating the voting through electronic means as the authorized agency.

The remote e-voting period commences on Monday, 16th September 2026, at 9.00 a.m. IST and ends on Sunday, 20th September, 2026 at 5.00 p.m. IST. During this period, Members of the Company holding shares, in physical or dematerialized form, as on the cut-off date of Monday, 14th September 2026 may cast their votes, electronically.

In case a person has become a Member of the Company after sending the Notice of the AGM but on or before the cut-off date i.e. September 14th, 2026, he/she may obtain the login ID and password by sending a request to NSDL on email ID: evoting@nsdl.co.in. However, if he/she is already registered with NSDL for remote e-voting then he/she can use his/her existing user ID and password to cast the vote.

Members will be able to attend the e-AGM or view the live webcast of AGM provided by NSDL at <https://www.evoting.nsdl.com>, by using their remote e-voting login credentials. Members are encouraged to use this facility of webcast.

Members are requested to note that:

- The remote e-voting module shall be disabled after 5.00 p.m. on September 20th, 2026;
- Once the vote is cast on a resolution, the Member shall not be allowed to change it Subsequently;
- The facility for e-voting shall be made available to the Members during the AGM as well, which would be for those Members who have not been able to vote during the remote e-voting period;
- Members who have cast their vote by remote e-voting prior to the AGM may also attend /participate in the e-AGM, but they shall not be entitled to vote again;
- A person whose name is recorded in the Register of Members or in the Register of Beneficial Owners maintained by the Depositories as on the cut-off date i.e. Monday, September 14th, 2026 and is otherwise not barred from doing so, only shall be entitled to avail the facility of remote e-voting as well as e-voting during the AGM.

The manner and procedure for e-voting for the all Members is set out in the Notice. In case of any query pertaining to e-voting, Members may refer the Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs) and e-voting user manual for shareholders available at the download section of www.evoting.nsdl.com or call on toll free no.: 1800-222-990 or at telephone nos.: 91 22 2499 4545/ 1800-222-990, who will address the grievance connected with facility for the voting by electronic means. Alternatively, Members may also write to Mr. Sadananda Poojary, Company Secretary and Compliance Officer at Investors@coffeedaygroup.com.

By order of the Board of Directors
For **Coffee Day Enterprises Limited**
Sd/-
Sadananda Poojary
Company Secretary and Compliance Officer

Date : 25th August 2026
Place: Bengaluru

Sanlayan Tech revenue grows six-fold to ₹140 cr

Our Bureau

Bengaluru

Integrated Indian defence company Sanlayan Technologies' revenue grew six-fold to ₹139.61 crore in FY26, while the company posted its first full-year net profit of ₹24.97 crore.

The company has an order backlog of ₹286 crore and a confirmed opportunity pipeline of over ₹2,000 crore. It is targeting annual net profit of more than ₹250 crore over the next four to five years.

Growth was driven primarily by programmes moving from the development phase into series production, while the company continued to balance new development mandates with production programmes.

Its clientele includes Hindustan Aeronautics Ltd (HAL), Bharat Electronics Ltd (BEL), the Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO), the armed forces and private system integrators.

RECENT ORDER

Sanlayan recently secured a production order worth more than ₹70 crore for the Uttam AESA Radar programme.

Its development order wins include critical subsystems for DRDO's next-gen-

eration drone detection radar and electronic warfare payloads for unmanned systems.

TDF PROJECT

The company also recently completed a technology development fund (TDF) project and handed over an indigenous jammer pod subsystem to the Indian Air Force following successful flight trials.

Sanlayan has also developed an anti-submarine warfare transmitter, which it describes as "global best-in-class".

The product is currently undergoing trials, and is expected to generate an additional opportunity of around ₹1,500 crore, over and above its existing ₹2,000 crore pipeline.

The company operates across radar, electronic warfare, avionics, power electronics and mission-critical embedded systems.

Commenting on the results, Rohan Gada, Co-founder and CEO, Sanlayan Technologies, said: "We are working closely with the forces, integrators and labs shaping India's defence future, and this shows us just how vast the opportunity ahead really is. Capturing this opportunity and building towards defence OEM status demands sustained and continuous investments in R&D."

PITTI ENGINEERING LIMITED
CIN: L29253TG1983PLC004141
PITTI
Regd. Office: 6-3-648/401, IV Floor, Padmaja Landmark, Somajiguda, Hyderabad-500082, Website: www.pitti.in, Ph: 040-23312774, Email : shares@pitti.in.

NOTICE OF 42ND ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING, E-VOTING INFORMATION
Notice is hereby given that the 42nd Annual General Meeting ("AGM") of the Company will be held on Friday, 18th September 2026 at 4:00 P.M.IST through Video Conferencing (VC) / Other Audio Visual Means (OAVM) facility, in accordance with General Circulars dated 22nd September 2025, read together with circulars dated 8th April 2020, 13th April 2020, 5th May 2020, 13th January 2021, 14th December 2021, 5th May 2022, 28th December 2022, 25th September 2023 and 19th September 2024 issued by Ministry of Corporate Affairs (collectively referred to as "MCA Circulars" and SEBI vide its circulars dated 12th May 2020, 15th January 2021, 3rd May 2022, 5th January 2023, 3rd October 2023 and 3rd October 2024 ("SEBI circulars") without the physical presence of the Members at the common venue.
In compliance with the above circulars, the notice of the AGM along with the Annual Report 2025-26 has been sent on 24th August 2026 by email to all the Members whose email IDs are registered with the Company / RTA / Depositories. For Members who have not registered their email address with the Company, RTA, or Depository, a letter with the web link to access the full Annual Report and AGM Notice has been dispatched by post.
The aforesaid documents are also available on the website of the Company, viz., www.pitti.in and on the websites of the Stock Exchanges where the equity shares of the Company are listed, i.e., BSE Limited (www.bseindia.com) and National Stock Exchange of India Limited (www.nseindia.com). The notice of the AGM is also available on the website of MUGF Intime India Private Limited, Registrar and Share Transfer Agent of the Company (MUGF) at <https://instavote.linkintime.co.in>. Pursuant to the provisions of Section 108 of the Companies Act, 2013 read with the Companies (Management and Administration) Rules, 2014 and Regulation 44 of the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 the Company is providing e-voting facility to its members to exercise their votes electronically for transacting the items of business enumerated in Notice of the 42nd AGM through MUGF. Members may note that all the business shall be transacted only through remote e-voting and voting by electronic means during the AGM.
The e-voting details are as follows:

a) Cut-off date for voting by the Members and participation in AGM through VC	Friday, 11 th September 2026
b) Date and time of commencement of remote e-voting	Tuesday, 15 th September 2026 (9:00 A.M.IST)
c) Date and end time for remote e-voting	Thursday, 17 th September 2026 (5:00 P.M.IST)
d) Starting time for e-voting on the date of and during AGM	Friday, 18 th September 2026 from 4:00 P.M.(IST). The closure time for e-voting will be announced in the AGM.
e) E-mail id and contact no. for assistance before or during the AGM	instameet@in.mnps , 022 - 4918 6000 / mfugf.com , 4918 6175

A Member whose name is recorded in the register of members or in the register of beneficiary owners maintained by depositories as on the cut-off date only shall be entitled to cast vote through the remote e-voting or e-voting at the AGM.
Any person who becomes a Member of the Company after the dispatch of the Notice of the AGM and holding shares as on the cut-off date i.e., 11th September 2026 may obtain the User ID and password by sending an email to enotices@in.mnps or by mentioning his / her Folio No / DP ID / and/or Client ID. However, if you are already registered with MUGF for e-voting then you can use your existing User ID and password for casting your vote.
The facility for e-voting through electronic voting system shall also be made available during the meeting on the date of AGM, for those Members who have not cast their vote by remote e-voting. Members who have cast their votes by remote e-voting, prior to the AGM may attend the meeting, but shall not be entitled to cast their vote again during the AGM.
The Members are requested to refer to the AGM notice for the procedure to cast their vote through remote e-voting or through the e-voting system during the AGM. In case you have not registered your email address and/or not updated your bank account mandate, please follow the below instructions:

Physical Holding	Pursuant to the SEBI Circulars, it is mandatory for all holders of physical securities to furnish PAN, KYC (contact details, bank details and specimen signatures), and nomination details. Shareholders of such folios wherein any one of the above mentioned documents/details are not updated, shall be eligible: • To lodge grievance or any service request only after registering the required details. • Any payments including dividend in respect of such folios shall only be made electronically with effect from April 1, 2024 upon registering the required details. In view of the above, members are requested to submit their PAN, KYC and nomination details to the Company's registrar MUGF Intime India Private Limited. The forms for updation of PAN, KYC, bank details and nomination viz., Forms ISR-1, ISR-2, ISR-3, SH-13 are available on the Company's website at www.pitti.in and on the RTA'S Website at https://web.in.mnps.mugf.com/KYC-downloads.html
Demat Holding	Members holding shares in demat mode are requested to register/update their email address/bank account details as per the process advised by the depository participant(s).

Members who have not claimed their Dividend for any Financial Years from 2018-19 to 2024-25 may write to the Company's Registrar MUGF to prevent their shares from being transferred to the Investor Education and Protection fund Authority (IEPFA). Members attending the AGM through VC/OAVM shall be reckoned for the purpose of quorum under Section 103 of the Companies Act 2013.
Members who would like to express their views or ask questions during the AGM may register themselves as a speaker by sending their request from their registered email address mentioning their name, DP ID and Client ID / folio number, PAN, mobile number at shares@pitti.in from 12th September 2026 (9:00 A.M.IST) to 15th September 2026 (3:00 P.M.IST). Those members who have registered themselves as a speaker will only be allowed to express their views / ask questions during the AGM. The Company reserves the right to restrict the number of speakers depending on the availability of time for the AGM.
Notice is further given pursuant to Regulation 42 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015, that the Company has fixed Friday, 11th September 2026 as the record date for the purpose of determining the eligible shareholders entitled to receive the final dividend for the financial year 2025-26. The final dividend, if declared at the AGM, will be paid within the stipulated period of 30 days from the conclusion of the AGM.
Pursuant to Income Tax Act, 2025 as amended by the Finance Acts ("the IT Act"), dividend income is taxable in the hands of the members and the Company is required to deduct tax at source ("TDS") from dividend paid to the members at the prescribed rates in the IT Act. Further details on TDS on dividend are available on the Company's website at <https://pitti.in/investors/corporate-governance/Shareholder%20Request%20Forms%20%26%20Unclaimed%20Dividend> and at the RTA's website at <https://web.in.mnps.mugf.com/client-downloads.html>

By Order of the Board
For **Pitti Engineering Limited**
Sd/-
Mary Monica Braganza
Company Secretary & Chief Compliance Officer
Place : Hyderabad
Date : 24th August 2026
FCS: 5532

ICICI Bank prices its \$1 b Senior Notes at 5.410%

Housing price index rises 1.1% sequentially: RBI

Mumbai: The All India House Price Index (HPI) increased 1.1 per cent during April-June FY27 as compared to the previous quarter, primarily driven by an increase in the index for cities such as Chandigarh, Lucknow and Thiruvananthapuram, according to RBI data released on Monday. The HPI registered an annual growth of 3.6 per cent in Q12026-27, same as in the corresponding quarter of the previous year. PTI

Sanjana B
Bengaluru

“What people are worried about with AI is just how it can take smaller vulnerabilities and chain them together to hack into a system,” Weiss said. “There probably is a way to quantify the number of attacks. But the bigger question that organisations have is: what about the existing vulnerabilities that haven’t been exploited, and

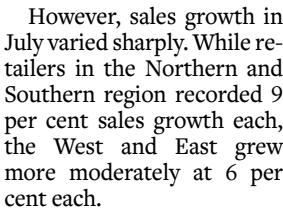
Our Bureau

Chennai

The facility will also support Dhaksha's growing defence portfolio, including surveillance and logistics applications.

Meenakshi Verma Ambwani
New Delhi

Kumar Rajagopalan, Executive Director and Chief Executive Officer, Retailers' Association of India, said, "July gave us two confirmations at once: Topline growth held up, and genuine store-level demand, which had softened through the summer, came back with it. That matters heading into



Footwear category sales grew 10 per cent, while the apparel segment grew 8 per

But the way the mid-market has evolved, and how enterprises have grown, especially with the Digital India push, cyber defence is something India has begun to adopt and absorb well," he added.

Avinash Nair
Ahmedabad

Gaurav Lath, Joint Managing Director of Concord Control Systems, explains how the locomotive is being built, the engineering and safety

Hydrogen protection,
ventilation, shut-off,
thermal protection —
everything has to be de-

standing on three months ago, though the categories that will matter most this festive season, i.e., big-ticket purchases are still growing well below the categories built into daily routine," it added.

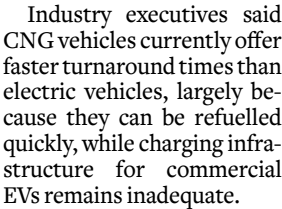
Mithun Dasgupta
Kolkata

During the last fiscal, Pocket Aces, currently a subsidiary of the company, acquired 100 per cent of the equity share capital of Finnet, a company engaged in influencer marketing, cre-

BUILD RELATIONS

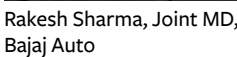
entirely through our internal accruals (with an initial payment of ₹325 crore) and is tied directly to their future financial performance," Managing Director Vikram Mehra said.

S Ronendra Singh
New Delhi



Industry veterans nevertheless pointed to the transition challenges for businesses. CNG and LPG vehicles emit less carbon dioxide and greenhouse gases and burn cleaner than petrol.

Amit Vijay Mohile



increased about 13 per cent to 11.8 lakh in H1 CY26, but the market expanded nearly 19 per cent to 1.11 crore, calculations based on FADA's VAHAN-derived data show.

MotoCorp's Xtreme 125R have meanwhile pushed sporty styling and digital equipment deeper into the commuter market, while Honda's Shine remains a major 125cc rival. Bajaj's re-

The CAQM's August 19 direction will therefore require the commercial vehicle market to make a rapid transition from established CNG technology to electric vehicles, with industry stakeholders flagging charging infrastructure and the higher upfront cost of EVs as key challenges.

With three more products and two new brands coming, the test is whether Bajaj's accelerated portfolio reset can translate into faster domestic growth and a recovery in market share.

Our Bureau

Chennai

The facility will also support Dhaksha's growing defence portfolio, including surveillance and logistics applications.

QUICKLY.

Infineon Tech acquires
C2i Semiconductors



Bengaluru: Infineon Technologies AG has announced the acquisition of C2i Semiconductors, a Bengaluru-based technology company specialising in software-defined multiphase controllers and smart power stages for AI data centre applications. Infineon said C2i Semiconductors' technology complements its portfolio of power semiconductors and power systems, enabling intelligent and scalable power delivery architectures from grid to core for AI servers and high-performance computing platforms. The acquisition further strengthens Infineon's position in power solutions for AI data centres, while expanding its engineering capabilities in India and reinforcing the country's role as a strategic innovation hub. **OUR BUREAU**

Trump regime moves to impose over \$100,000 fee for H-1B visas

CURBING IMMIGRATION. US President invokes law to restrict entry of certain foreign nationals

Reuters
New York

US President Donald Trump's administration on Monday released a proposed regulation to codify an unprecedented fee of more than \$100,000 on new H-1B visas for highly-skilled foreign workers that has been blocked by the courts. The fee, first temporarily imposed by Trump last year, dramatically raises the cost of visas that are heavily relied on in the tech, education and research sectors. A federal judge in June ruled that the fee was illegal and blocked the Trump administration from collecting it. A Boston-based appeals court is reviewing that decision while a different court considers whether a judge properly rejected a challenge to the fee by a major business group.

Trump's temporary fee increase expires in September, one year after it was issued. The proposed rule by the US Department of Homeland Security, posted in the Federal Register on Monday, would make a fee of \$103,265 permanent. It could be finalised by the end of the year. The H-1B programme allows US employers to hire foreign workers with training in speciality fields and offers 65,000 visas annually, with another 20,000 for workers with advanced degrees, approved for three to six years. Those visas typically came with fees between \$2,000 and \$5,000 before Trump's order. The fee would not apply to visas granted to foreign citizens already in the US on student visas, who make up a large share of new H-1B recipients, or to renewals of current visas.



NEED-BASED HIRING. Many firms have said that the visa programme is needed to employ qualified workers

RESTRICTED ENTRY Trump, a Republican, and other critics of the H-1B programme say it is abused by many companies who replace American workers with cheaper foreign labour. But business groups and many individual companies have said the visa programme is needed to address a lack of qualified American workers

for some jobs and to allow US businesses to recruit top talent. About 70 employers had paid the \$100,000 fee on a total of 85 visa applications as of late February, according to court filings. In imposing the fee, Trump invoked the President's power under immigration law to restrict the entry of certain foreign nationals

who would be detrimental to US interests. The fee is being challenged by the US Chamber of Commerce, the largest US business lobbying group, Democratic-led states and a coalition of unions and employers. Those lawsuits could be amended to challenge the rule proposed this week once it is finalised. The lawsuits claim that Trump's power to restrict entry does not allow him to override the law that created the H-1B visa programme. The states and groups that sued also say that the Homeland Security Department cannot impose fees, taxes or other means to generate revenue for the US without permission from Congress. The Trump administration has maintained that the fee is not a traditional tax and that courts have little power to question the president's authority to restrict entry into the country.

Jaishankar, Putin discuss trade, energy, nuclear ties

Press Trust of India
Moscow



External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar with Russian President Vladimir Putin

External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar on Monday called on Russian President Vladimir Putin, as the two sides discussed economic ties, focusing on key areas such as trade, energy, fertilizers and nuclear cooperation. Jaishankar landed in Moscow on Sunday for a two-day visit, ahead of Putin's expected visit to New Delhi for the BRICS leaders' summit next month. The meeting assumes significance as India and Russia seek to deepen their economic engagement and expand cooperation in a range of areas. **GOOD REPORT** Jaishankar said the two sides had held a meeting of the inter-governmental commission earlier in the day and had a "good report" on their economic cooperation. "I think our economic operation, trade, energy, fertilizers, nuclear, other dimensions as well — I would

be pleased to speak about it in detail. Overall, I think our economic cooperation has grown very significantly," the Foreign Minister said. Putin said Russia was increasing fertilizer supplies to India and was ready to continue doing so, according to the state-run TASS news agency. "We are doing everything we can to fully meet the needs of Indian farmers and the agricultural sector, increasing these supplies and standing ready to continue doing so," Putin said.

'US, India ties continue to grow stronger through innovation'

Our Bureau
Hyderabad

The decades-long economic partnership between the United States and India continues to grow stronger through innovation, shared security interests and economic cooperation, Sergio Gor, US Ambassador to India, said. Gor visited the Tata Lockheed Martin Aerostructures Ltd (TLMAL) facility on Monday, highlighting the commitment to industrial development and reinforcing the deepening strategic partnership and shared commitment to aerospace and

defence industrial cooperation in India. The Ambassador toured the production line that manufactures empennages for the C-130J Super Hercules. The Hyderabad plant is emblematic of the critical role Indian industry plays in supporting the world's most versatile and proven airlifter. **SHARED COMMITMENT** "The production of critical structures for the C-130J in India, a platform operated by both our nations, is a strong example of the growing industrial and defence cooperation between the US and India. Partnerships like these support high-skilled jobs,



CRUCIAL PARTNERSHIP. US Ambassador Sergio Gor reviewed advanced aerospace manufacturing during his visit to the Tata-Lockheed Martin facility in Hyderabad on Monday **ANI**

strengthen resilient supply chains and advance our shared vision for a free, open, and secure Indo-Pacific," he said. The visit highlighted the longstanding collaboration between Lockheed Martin and Tata Advanced Sys-

tems Ltd, as well as the companies' shared commitment to expanding advanced aerospace manufacturing capabilities in India to support of the country's defence modernisation and 'Make in India' initiatives. "Tata Advanced Systems' partnership with Lockheed Martin has proven over time to supply world-class aerospace structures for their key programmes, including the C-130J," Sukaran Singh, Chief Executive Officer and Managing Director, TASL said. "This partnership has now extended to MRO, which will be operational soon. Additionally, both parties are ex-

panding cooperation on full platforms for Make in India, should we get the opportunity. Both sides will bring their existing world class capabilities to support the MoD," he added. The Tata Advanced Systems' MRO opening is planned for December of this year with aircraft arrival slated for Spring 2027. "Through our collaboration with Indian industry, we have established world-class aerospace manufacturing capabilities that directly support the global network of C-130J operators," said Trish Pagan, Vice-President, Air Mobility and Maritime Missions.

Trump threatens 50% tariffs on all cars and trucks from Canada

Reuters
Washington

President Donald Trump sought to boost pressure on Canada on Monday, warning that US tariffs on all cars, trucks and automotive parts from the US' northern neighbour would be increased to 50 per cent starting January 1 after trade talks collapsed over the weekend. The trade deal on the table would have cut the top-line tariff rate on Canadian cars and light-duty trucks from 25 per cent to 15 per cent and the tariffs on aluminium and steel from 50 per cent to 25 per cent but the deal col-

lapsed on Friday over a number of points of contention including whether the US tariff relief would have applied to medium or heavy-duty trucks. "Build in the US and there are zero tariffs. Canada will be treated like a State no longer!," Trump wrote. "On trade, and in other ways, also, they are among the worst nations in the World to deal with. They feel entitled, and yet, we don't need Canada, they need us!" Trump said. The White House did not immediately respond to a request for comment seeking more details on the threatened tariffs.

Ahead of the festival season, Amazon and Flipkart tighten seller cancellation penalties

Jyoti Banthia
Bengaluru

Amazon and Flipkart have tightened penalties for marketplace sellers, raising cancellation and other charges at a time when sellers are preparing for the upcoming festive season and facing higher operating costs. Amazon has revised cancellation fees for sellers using its 'easy ship' and 'self-ship' services, linking the charge to the value of the order instead of the earlier referral-fee-based structure. From August 17, sellers will be charged 10 per cent of the order value for cancellations on orders below ₹10,000, 8 per cent for orders between ₹10,001 and ₹50,000, 5 per cent for orders between ₹50,001 and ₹1 lakh and 2 per cent for orders above ₹1 lakh, according to a seller communication reviewed by *businessline*. The charge applies when a seller cancels an order for reasons other than a buyer request. It can also be levied if Amazon cancels an order because the seller fails to ship and confirm it within 24 hours of the estimated shipping date. Amazon is also increasing its closing fees from September 7, citing higher fuel and logistics costs. The fee will

rise by ₹1 for products priced up to ₹500 and by ₹3 for products priced above ₹500. The increase will apply across its fulfilment centre, easy ship and seller flex channels, according to a separate seller communication. **PENALTY STRUCTURE** Flipkart, meanwhile, has introduced a new per-order penalty structure for sellers who have been on the platform for at least three months, according to people familiar with the matter. Under the new structure, sellers will face penalties ranging from ₹30 to ₹90 depending on the nature of the order failure. A ₹30 penalty is

applicable when a seller fails to hand over an order to Flipkart's logistics partner by the agreed dispatch-by date (DBD). The penalty rises to ₹60 when a seller cancels an order after receiving it from a customer. If a seller misses the DBD and subsequently cancels the order, the penalty is ₹90. Amazon and Flipkart did not immediately respond to *businessline*'s queries. The moves by the two largest e-commerce marketplaces come ahead of the festive sales period, when order volumes typically rise sharply and marketplace sellers increase inventory and fulfilment capacity.

ciency, combined with strong recurring revenue and engagement fundamentals, is becoming the new baseline for investor screening," said Anuj Tandon, Partner, Emerging Markets, Bitkraft Ventures.

Gaming investments plummet in the face of investor demand for sustainable monetisation

Vallari Sanzgiri
Mumbai

Demand for sustainable monetisation and capital efficiency has contracted deal sizes for gaming investments globally. Viewing the trend as a funding reset, industry bodies in India suggest a shift away from funding-led expansion to mature investment ecosystem where companies that can assure profitability have a better chance at attracting capital. Investors focused on gaming companies now demand stronger retention, capital efficiency and sustainable monetisation. Particularly in India, gaming funding went from \$133 million in 2025 to \$42.5 million so far in 2026. This despite the market crossing a \$1 billion revenue mark in 2025. Industry leaders viewing the development as a reset argue the trend to be one of the most significant changes in gaming investment

Viewing the trend as a funding reset, industry bodies suggest a shift from funding-led expansion to mature investment ecosystem

strategy over the past decade. The representatives from Nazara Technologies and Bitkraft argued that the market opportunity remains compelling, even as investors become more disciplined about capital deployment, considering the increasingly engaged player base, rising consumer spending and growing number of homegrown gaming companies. **TARGETED CAPITAL** Further, new forms of targeted capital are emerging, such as the \$20 million non-

dilutive user-acquisition financing secured by Metasports Interactive from London-based firm Metica to scale Hitwicket globally. "Companies that can consistently retain players, build communities around their products and create multiple engagement touchpoints are proving to be far more resilient businesses. The strongest gaming companies are building long-term player relationships rather than chasing short-term growth spikes," said Nitish Mittersain, Founder, Chief Executive Officer and Managing Director, Nazara Technologies. "What's changed isn't investor appetite for gaming, it's the bar for what a fundable gaming business looks like. AI is now a genuine differentiator, not a buzzword. Studios using AI to cut development cycles, personalise live-ops, improve player retention, and build large distribution moats are able to do more with leaner teams and tighter burn. That effi-

ciency, combined with strong recurring revenue and engagement fundamentals, is becoming the new baseline for investor screening," said Anuj Tandon, Partner, Emerging Markets, Bitkraft Ventures.

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Global Brain Scientist Brings the Science of Positive Thinking to Kohinoor Management School students

Kohinoor Management School (KMS), Mumbai concluded its flagship IGNITE 21 induction programme with an inspiring international masterclass by Dr. Rahul Arun Bharadwaj, Founder of The Art of Mental Health Management and Brain Scientist at the Lieber Institute for Brain Development, Johns Hopkins Medicine, Baltimore, USA. Joining live from Baltimore, Dr. Bharadwaj engaged Kohinoor Management School's (KMS) PGDM students for over three hours on "The Science of Positive Thinking." Drawing upon neuroscience, he explained how thought patterns and positive habits influence behaviour, emotional resilience, decision-making, leadership and long-term professional success. The session marked the culmination of IGNITE 21, Kohinoor Management School's 21-day transformational induction programme designed to prepare not only for professional Degree, but for the challenges of life and the AI-driven corporate world. Through daily "Sparks" covering Purpose, Belief, Emotional Intelligence, Leadership, Curiosity, Artificial Intelligence, Entrepreneurship and Personal Brand, students were encouraged to develop confidence, character, creativity and global thinking. Speaking on the occasion, CA Sunil G. Karve, Hon. Chairman, Governing Board, Kohinoor Education Trust (KET), said, "The world has become our classroom. At Kohinoor, we want our students to learn not only from textbooks and faculty, but from outstanding minds across the world. As Artificial Intelligence transforms business, our young managers must combine technological readiness with scientific thinking, emotional intelligence, resilience and strong human values."



MIT-WPU Pune Signs Strategic MoU with Berlin School of Business and Innovation



PUNE—MIT World Peace University (MIT-WPU), Pune's Ram Charan School of Business has officially signed a strategic Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with the Berlin School of Business and Innovation (BSBI), Germany, reinforcing a shared commitment to advancing global higher education. The landmark agreement was signed by Hon. Dr. Rahul V. Karad, Executive President, MIT-WPU, Pune, and Prof. Dr. Kyriakos Kouveliotis Provost, BSBI School of Business and Innovation (BSBI, Berlin) and Chief Academic Officer, Global University Systems, Germany (GGG), in the presence of Prof. Shiv Tripathi, Dean of the Faculty of Economics and Business Administration, BSBI, Berlin and Mr Ganesh Pokale, Registrar, MIT-WPU Pune. This collaboration will promote academic and cultural exchange, joint research, and international mobility while creating opportunities for technology-driven learning and innovation to prepare graduates with global competencies.

Goa Shipyard Limited Celebrates 80th Independence Day

Goa Shipyard Limited (GSL), a premier Defence Public Sector Undertaking under the Ministry of Defence, celebrated India's 80th Independence Day by commemorating 150 years of 'Vande Mataram' and focusing on the national theme 'Yuva Shakti for Viksit Bharat@2047'. During the event, Chairman & Managing Director Shri Brajesh Kumar Upadhyay highlighted GSL's landmark elevation to Schedule 'A' CPSE status and reinforced the shipyard's vital role in bolstering India's maritime security, pushing for technological self-reliance, and advancing Aatmanirbhar Bharat. Key Points & Strategic Priorities: Historic Institutional Upgrade: GSL has been officially elevated to Schedule 'A' CPSE status. This upgradation reflects the collective dedication of the workforce and marks a key milestone in GSL's transformation into a globally competitive shipbuilding enterprise. Strengthening Maritime Security: Beyond standard shipbuilding, GSL's core mission is to strengthen India's maritime security architecture and drive strategic self-reliance. CMD Upadhyay noted that India's emergence as a leading maritime power provides major opportunities for indigenous manufacturing. R&D and Indigenisation Roadmap: Moving forward, GSL is heavily prioritizing: Expanding research and development (R&D) an design capabilities. Accelerating indigenisation and creating intellectual property. Embracing digital and process excellence to boost productivity across all functions. Operational Excellence ("Zero Avoidable Delay"): Alignment with National Maritime Visions: Employees have been urged to capitalize on upcoming opportunities stemming from Maritime India Vision 2030 and Maritime Amrit Kaal Vision 2047 to help cement India's status as a leading maritime nation. Celebration Highlights & Community Initiatives: The ceremony featured the ceremonial hoisting of the National Flag, a Guard of Honour, cultural performances by school children, a CISF Combat Drill, and the felicitation of outstanding employees and students.



Jawaharlal Nehru Technological University Hyderabad Hosts ICAIBTS 2026: Advancing AI and Biotechnology for a Sustainable Future



The ICAIBTS 2026 conference, which was hosted by Jawaharlal Nehru Technological University Hyderabad from 10 to 12 August 2026. The key details of the content include: The Core Theme: The conference focused on the convergence of artificial intelligence, biotechnology, and engineering. Rather than operating in isolation, these fields are combining to turn complex biological data into scalable, sustainable technologies for societal benefit. Key Focus Areas: Discussions spanned several interdisciplinary tracks, including AI-enabled healthcare and precision medicine, advanced robotics, climate-resilient agriculture, environmental protection, and responsible AI policy. Speaker Highlights: Prominent experts highlighted the necessity of using AI to analyse massive biological datasets, the role of AI in drug repurposing to manage healthcare costs, and the importance of global research collaboration among developing countries

QUICKLY.



Crude oil falls ahead of US' new Iran sanctions

Singapore: Crude oil prices slipped more than \$1 a barrel on Monday as investors took profits ahead of an expected announcement from the US about imposing more sanctions on Iran that may further disrupt supplies from West Asia. Brent crude futures fell \$1.22, or 1.29 per cent, to \$93.17 by 0035 GMT, while US West Texas Intermediate crude was at \$85.86 a barrel, down \$1.2, or 1.38 per cent. **REUTERS**

Gold rally gains steam on technical buying

Gold prices pushed to their highest in more than three months on Monday, as technical buyers piled into a rally driven by the US Treasury's recent buyback announcement and a weaker dollar ahead of this week's inflation data and Jackson Hole Symposium. Spot gold rose 1.6 per cent to \$4,677.14 per ounce by 1334GMT, hitting its highest level since May 14. US gold futures for December delivery rose 1.2 per cent to \$4,734.70 per ounce. **REUTERS**

Palm oil falls over 1% on weaker CBOT soya oil

Kuala Lumpur: Malaysian palm oil futures slipped more than 1 per cent on Monday, snapping a five-session winning streak, as weaker Chicago soybean oil prices weighed on the market amid softer expectations for US biofuel demand. The benchmark palm oil contract for November delivery on the Bursa Malaysia Derivatives Exchange was down 72 ringgit, or 1.43 per cent, at 4,946 ringgit (\$1,224.26) a tonne at the close. **REUTERS**

As planting window closes, farmers cover 96% of normal kharif area

GAP NARROWS. Sowing deficit shrinks to 0.3% as the coverage picked up last week, reaching 40 lakh hectares

Our Bureau
New Delhi

The sowing area under all kharif crops reached nearly 96 per cent of the season's normal area of 1,104.46 lakh hectares (lh), while the deficit from the year-ago level narrowed to 0.3 per cent as of August 21. The pace of sowing increased during the period from August 15 to 21, as farmers raced to finish as early as possible before the planting window closes.

Farmers have planted kharif crops in over 40 lh during August 15-21 as against nearly 35 lh a year ago, helping the country to narrow the deficit in sowing area, which was about 2 per cent until August 7.

The sowing area in the on-going kharif season reached 1,056.7 lakh hectares as of August 21, compared with 1,072.77 lakh hectares in the

Progress card (lakh hectare)			
	2025	2026	% change
Paddy	418.29	405.10	-3.2
Pulses	112.14	113.63	1.3
Shri Anna cum Coarse cereals	179.81	176.36	-1.9
Oilseeds	188.69	188.37	-0.2
Sugarcane	58.87	58.44	-0.3
Cotton	108.73	108.45	-0.7
All Crops	1,072.77	1,056.7	-0.3

As of Aug 21; Source: Agriculture Ministry

same period last year, the Agriculture Ministry said in its weekly update on Monday.

PADDY DOWN 3.2%
The main cereal for the kharif season, paddy, is down by 3.2 per cent to 405.10 lakh hectares compared with 418.29 lh a year ago. The deficit was 4.4 per cent until August 7, and narrowing of the gap indicates better progress in transplanting during

the past fortnight. The government has set a production target of 123.15 million tonnes (mt) of rice for kharif 2026.

Overall, the decline in rice area is mainly attributed to substantial reductions reported in Madhya Pradesh, Odisha, Maharashtra, Karnataka, Telangana and Jharkhand. The major decreases in area have been reported in Karnataka (3.09

lakh hectares), Telangana (2.45 lakh hectares), Jharkhand (1.88 lh), Madhya Pradesh (1.75 lh), Odisha (1.63 lh), Maharashtra (1.50 lh), Andhra Pradesh (1.26 lh), Tamil Nadu (1.18 lh), Uttar Pradesh (0.70 lh) and Gujarat (0.27 lh).

PULSES GAIN

The area under all pulses reached 113.63 lh compared to 112.14 lh, while the area for oilseeds was 188.37 lh compared to 188.69 lh. Oilseeds acreage this season exceeded the year-ago level until August 7, with a higher area under soyabean, groundnut and sesame, but dipped as of August 14 following a drop in soybean acreage. Among the 28.92 mt oilseeds production target set by the government for the current season, soybean is targeted at 14.85 mt and groundnut at 11.35 mt.

In oilseeds, soybean

dropped to 121.35 lh from 122.76 lh, but groundnut continued its lead at 48.79 lh, up from 48.22 lh. Among pulses, arhar sowing reached 43.86 lh compared to 43.44 lh a year ago, and urad (black gram) rose to 24.38 lh from 21.72 lh. However, moong (green gram) at 32.68 lh slipped from 33.93 lh.

The coverage of nutri/coarse cereals has been reported as 1.9 per cent lower at 176.36 lh compared with 179.81 lh. The area under jowar reached 13.41 lh, up from 12.61 lh a year ago, while bajra increased to 64.68 lh from 63.33 lh. However, ragi decreased to 4.81 lh, down from 6.60 lh, and maize decreased to 89.51 lh, down from 93.30 lh.

Cotton acreage is now a notch lower at 108.45 lh from 108.73 lh, while jute and mesta coverage was higher at 6.34 lh from 6.23 lh year-ago, data show.

Govt lifts ban on wheat, atta, maida, suji exports



EXPORT WINDFALL. The full reopening of export channels is expected to benefit farmers and exporters by providing access to overseas markets and potentially improving price realisation **PTI**

Our Bureau
New Delhi

After four years, the government on Monday removed the ban on export of wheat and wheat-based flour products, including atta, maida, semolina (suji), wholemeal atta and resultant atta, marking a major policy reversal as record domestic production and comfortable supplies reduced concerns over food security.

The Directorate-General of Foreign Trade (DGFT) amended the export policy of wheat and durum wheat as well as wheat or meslin flour (*atta*), *maida*, *semolina*, wholemeal *atta* and resultant atta from "prohibited" to "free", with immediate effect.

"The export policy of the above mentioned products/items shall accordingly be 'free' with immediate effect," the DGFT stated in two separate notifications, one covering durum wheat and wheat and the other covering wheat flour products including *atta*, *maida* and *semolina*.

EASING SITUATION

The restrictions were originally imposed in May 2022, when wheat exports were prohibited amid concerns over domestic availability

and rising prices. The restrictions were subsequently extended to wheat flour and related products in August 2022.

However, with the situation in the domestic market easing due to record production and robust wheat stocks, the government allowed a cumulative 5 million tonnes of wheat and 1 million tonnes of wheat products to be exported this year, in February and April.

EXPORT CHANNEL

The full reopening of export channels is expected to benefit farmers and exporters by providing access to overseas markets and potentially improving price realisation.

It could also help Indian exporters regain the markets lost during the four-year restriction period, particularly in neighbouring and import-dependent countries.

GLOBAL CUSHION

For global markets, the timing is significant as disruptions to Black Sea grain flows have tightened global wheat supplies and pushed international prices higher. Additional supplies from the world's second-largest wheat producer could ease availability for import-dependent markets in Asia, Africa and West Asia.

Global sea temperature up at record high on El Nino impact

Srikrishnan PC
Chennai

The daily global average Sea surface temperature (SST) has surged to a record, with a temperature of 21.1°C on August 22, exceeding the previous record of 21.09°C set in March 2024, according to a report by the Copernicus Climate Change Service, implemented by the European Centre for Medium-Range Weather Forecasts (ECMWF).

UNUSUALLY LATE

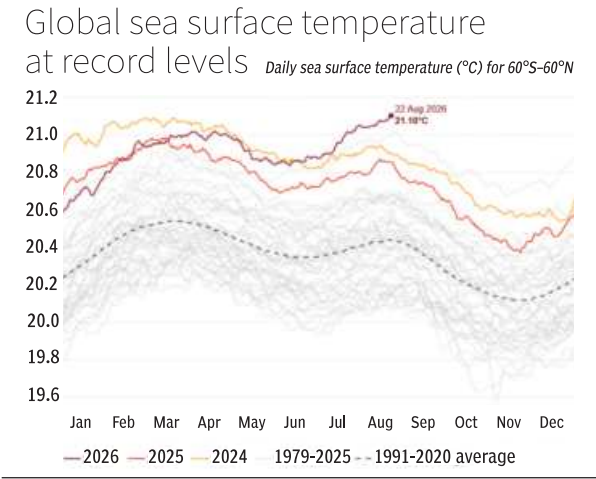
It is an unusually late reading for this time of year, with the long-term warming of the ocean compounded by a

strengthening El Nino event.

Normally, the warmest global ocean temperatures occur in March and April, after the austral summer. But this has occurred in August. It also beats the previous highest August value, reached in 2023 at 20.98°C.

This comes on the heels of a series of monthly SST records and near-records observed across the extra-polar ocean (60°S to 60°N) throughout 2026, highlighting the persistent warmth observed across much of the global ocean.

The tropical Pacific is rapidly warming, and a powerful El Nino is taking shape, adding to the already long-term warming of the ocean



Source: CS3/ECMWF

due to climate change. The World Meteorological Or-

ganization said El Nino is likely to strengthen in the

ISMA blames speculation for sugar price surge, seeks tightening of stock limits

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Under pressure from the government, private sugar millers on Monday blamed speculation for the current rise in sugar prices ahead of Dussehra and Deepavali. However, the statistics provided by the millers themselves indicate a shortage and realising this, the government allowed the import of 1 million tonnes (mt) of raw sugar at zero duty to augment domestic availability.

The Indian Sugar & Bio-Energy Manufacturers Association (ISMA) held a press conference on Monday, asserting that there is no shortage of sugar in the country and that prices in the retail market are expected to come down. India's production and stock position remain fundamentally comfortable.

ISMA President Niraj Shirgaokar stated that prices had risen due to various factors, including speculative buying by traders and bulk consumers, as well as lower production resulting from adverse weather conditions. He denied the involvement of mills in creating an artificial scarcity and inflating ex-mill prices.

STOCKHOLDING LIMIT

The industry body demanded that the stockholding limit on traders, currently 400 tonnes, should be brought down to 200 tonnes.

The ISMA President rejected allegations of diversion of sugar to make ethanol as the main factor for the price hike.

"The Ethanol Blending Programme is not competing with food-grade sugar, and it is not responsible for the current price movement... This year, around 2.9



Niraj Shirgaokar, President, ISMA, addressing the media in New Delhi on Monday **ANI**

mt have been diverted till July, with the full season expected to settle around 3 mt, well within our historical range of 2-4 mt," he said.

He said that prices had started to ease following the government's decision to allow duty-free imports of 1 mt of raw sugar.

NET OUTPUT 27.9 MT

Sharing the statistics, he stated that the closing stock

of sugar at the end of September 2026 would be 3.5 million tonnes (mt).

However, he portrayed a positive outcome for the first month (October 2026) of the new season, saying that mills would start operations around October 15 and could produce approximately 1 to 1.2 mt, even though millers admitted that historically, sugar production in October has not exceeded 0.5 mt. He noted that the demand for October would be between 2.4 and 2.5 mt.

Ex-mill prices have eased in the last few days and are currently ruling around ₹55-56 per kg in Maharashtra and Uttar Pradesh, the ISMA said.

India's net sugar production (after diversion to ethanol) is estimated around 27.9 mt in the 2025-26 season (October-September), while the opening stock on October 1, 2025, was 4.9 mt.

Retail, mill gate sugar prices drop after 2-month rally

Subramani Ra Mancombu
Chennai

Sugar prices declined in mills' sales for open markets and retail outlets on Monday after nearly a two-month rally, following various measures taken by the Centre.

"Ex-mill and tender prices (in Maharashtra) of sugar have declined by over 10 per cent since hitting a peak of ₹6,500 a quintal on Thursday (August 20). On Monday, the prices quoted were between ₹5,500 and ₹5,700 a quintal for S-30 grade," said an industry source, who did not wish to be quoted.

M-30 grade sugar prices have dropped to below ₹6,100 from ₹6,950 during the same period. "There are no buyers in view of the falling prices and other measures taken by the government," the source said.

Industry sources said the government was cracking down on sugar traders in different States to check hoard-



PRICES RETREAT. Retail prices of sugar dropped a tad to ₹63.05 a kg from a record high of ₹63.12 on Sunday

ing. Besides, the physical stocks with mills are being monitored, keeping the sector on its toes.

DUTY-FREE IMPORTS

Retail prices of sugar dropped a tad to ₹63.05 a kg from a record high of ₹63.12 on Sunday, data from the Price Monitoring Division of the Department of Consumer Affairs showed. In Chennai, Delhi, Mumbai, Kolkata and Hyderabad, the prices declined by at least ₹3 a kg on Monday.

Sources said the prices in Pune dropped nearly 20 per cent to ₹60 a kg during the weekend, down from ₹72 last week.

Sugar prices began dropping from August 21, after the government permitted duty-free imports of 1 million tonnes of raw sugar. The import window will be open till October 31.

At least 4 lakh tonnes are on their way, while industry sources said more could land by October 15 in time to meet festival demand.

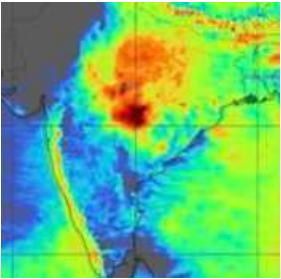
Low-pressure systems continue to line up over Bay, fuelled by warm temperatures

Vinson Kurian
Thiruvananthapuram

The Bay of Bengal is beginning to look like a busy monsoon assembly line, with one low-pressure system after another lining up to keep the basin active into early September.

Warm sea-surface temperatures across the north and central Bay are providing ample fuel. Some systems are forming *in situ*, while others are arriving as remnants of storms that have crossed the West Pacific and South China Sea.

The southern Arabian Sea and the adjoining northern equatorial Indian Ocean have warmed in tandem. That helped sustain moisture-laden westerly to south-westerly winds across the West Coast, feeding into the



Monsoon gains could extend along the West Coast by the weekend, as fresh Bay circulations develop

prevailing low-pressure area over West Bengal and adjoining Jharkhand and north Odisha. The payoff has been a sharp burst of rain along the coast from Mangaluru to Thiruvananthapuram, dampening Onam festivities.

MORE RAIN IN STORE

Forecast models suggest that the rainfall footprint over

East and North-East India could gradually push westward, bringing central and west Madhya Pradesh and parts of northern Maharashtra, including the Nagpur region, into the developing wet spell. More systems are expected to form over the Bay and move across eastern and Central India.

RAIN DEFICIT

As of Sunday, the rainfall deficit over East and North-East India widened to 27 per cent, while the South Peninsula was running 23 per cent below normal. The North-West was at 11 per cent below normal, and Central India at 3 per cent below normal, both still within the IMD's broad normal range, though weaker than their recent performance. For the country as a whole, the deficit stood at 14 per cent.

Risk-averse traders can avoid natural gas futures

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Natural gas futures, after falling in July, have been consolidating for nearly a month. While the bears seem to have lost momentum, there are no concrete signs of a rally either.

COMMODITY CALL.

The September contract, now at ₹269 (per mmBtu), has largely been oscillating between ₹257 and ₹276 for a month now.

Therefore, the next leg of the trend depends on the direction of the breach of this region.

If natural gas futures (September) break out of ₹276, the near-term outlook could turn positive, possibly

lifting the contract to ₹290, a resistance level. The subsequent barrier is at ₹300.

However, if the contract slips and breaches support at ₹257, it could extend the decline to ₹238, a notable support level.

Given that the trend before the ongoing consolidation phase was bearish, there is a negative bias now. That said, the bears have lost momentum, and going short at the current level carries higher risk.

TRADE STRATEGY

Traders with high risk tolerance can short natural gas futures (September) now at ₹269. Place the stop-loss at ₹280. When the contract slips to ₹260, alter the stop-loss to ₹268.

Book profits at ₹240. Risk-averse traders can avoid this trade.

Gourmet Popcornica launches non-GMO hybrid popcorn maize seeds

Our Bureau
Mangaluru

Gourmet Popcornica on Monday launched two high-expansion non-GMO popcorn maize hybrid seeds — Krisna459 and Godari234.

Vice-President CP Radhakrishnan launched Krisna459 and Godari234 at Gourmet Popcornica's factory in Musunuru, Andhra Pradesh, in the presence of State Governor S Abdul Nazeer and Chief Minister N Chandrababu Naidu.

CUTTING DEPENDENCE

A Gourmet Popcornica statement said that the launch marked the next step in a longer journey with farmers. With Krisna459 and Godari234, farmers now gain something more fundamental — ownership of the

genetics itself. Rather than depend on imported hybrid seeds, they can grow a hybrid bred, tested and owned in India, built to deliver higher yields, processor-grade quality and a far greater share of the value their crop creates.

For years, India's premium popcorn, the kind sold in cinemas and gourmet retail, depended heavily on seed and grain imported from the US, Argentina, Brazil and South Africa.

The statement said that Krisna459 and Godari234 were the home-grown answer to dependence on imports.

Bred and trial-tested across five growing seasons in partnership with India's leading maize research institutions, both hybrids match the kernel size and popping expansion of the leading im-

ported benchmark, while offering the pest tolerance, short duration, and yield Indian farmers need.

LOCAL HARVEST

India's popcorn maize market has grown from around 50,000 tonnes in 2014-15 to 1.3 lakh tonnes in 2025-26, with domestic production now meeting close to 70 per cent of national demand, the statement said.

Quoting Radhakrishnan, it said: "Today, we take a small but firm step toward Aatmanirbhar Bharat — not a slogan, but a seed. Every acre cultivated with this indigenous hybrid is an acre that no longer needs an imported alternative, and every such acre is a saving redirected into the pockets of our own farmers, and the economic development of our great country."

QUICKLY.

Godrej Group to invest ₹20,000 cr in Haryana

New Delhi: The Godrej Industries Group said it plans to invest about ₹20,000 crore in Haryana, with the potential to create around 40,000 jobs. The group signed a memorandum of understanding with the State government in the presence of Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini, outlining its future investment plans in the State, the Godrej Industries Group said in a statement. **■**

MIAL to demolish Mumbai airport T1 from Jan 15

New Delhi: The Adani Group-operated Mumbai airport will start demolishing a part of Terminal 1 from January 15, 2027, and has commenced redistribution of air traffic to Terminal 2 as well as to the Navi Mumbai International Airport, according to a letter. The Mumbai International Airport Ltd (MIAL) operates Mumbai's Chatrapati Shivaji Maharaj International Airport, which currently has capacity of over 50 million and handles over 950 flight movements daily. **■**

ESIC ‘nudge’ to recover social security overdue of ₹2,400 cr

SOFT APPROACH. Emulating the I-T Dept, ESIC is using chatbots to press for recovery

Dalip Singh
New Delhi

The ESIC has launched a crackdown to recover ₹2,473 crore social security money through 6.45 lakh ‘Recovery Certificates’ linked to employers, pending for over a decade due to structural and legal hurdles.

Taking a leaf out of successful “Nudge (Non-Intrusive Usage of Data to Guide and Enable)” campaign of the Income Tax department to recover evaded taxes, the ESIC too decided to give up the traditional coercive action and use technology to prompt owners to submit the amount due to each of them, said Ministry sources privy to the development.

Under the ESIC Act, the officials are authorised to issue orders for attachment and sale of the employer’s movable or immovable property and also arrest or detain defaulters in extreme non-compliance cases.

Overall, 24,521 attempts were made before and after the chatbots were used to launch the campaign to recover ₹1,029 crore arrears across the country from employers as part of the Social Security Code, 2020.

The ESIC managed to get around ₹77 crore before the use of technology, sources said.

The ESIC, however, recovered over ₹3.27 crore after deploying the chatbot on February 2 alone in respect of companies located in Haryana. The system targeted individual companies, each holding arrears of ₹5 lakh or more, as specified in recovery certificates carrying valid mobile numbers. The nudge messages were sent on all 133 mobile numbers registered in official records as that of either owners or other authorised senior officials of firms but it was delivered to 103.

Of that, 79 messages were read and the remaining 27 ‘failed’. Many of those who

Year-wise breakup of companies’ ESIC dues (₹ in crs)	
Period	Amount involved in recovery
0-2 years	765.32
2-5 years	582.90
5-10 years	573.67
More than 10 years	442.43
Total	2,364.32
Source: Ministry of Labour and Employment	

read messages paid their dues, sources stated.

ATTEMPTS MADE

The second effort was made on February 23, with a bigger sample of 1,191 target recovery certificates. Of that, the texts were sent to 957 mobile numbers of targeted audiences. It was delivered to 938 mobile phones, having a delivery rate of 98 per cent.

Among them, 660 read the messages while it failed to get delivered to 234 remaining numbers.

After a gap of two months, the ESIC launched another wave of the chatbot recovery

campaign. On May 1, it chose a bigger sample of 12,237 targeted audiences, sensing success from previous attempts.

The nudge messages were dispatched to 9,476 mobile phones, with 9,206 receiving them, which was a 97 per cent strike rate, as 6,772 read them.

Another exercise was done on May 2 with the biggest so far sample of 17,714 targeted audiences.

The messages were sent to 14,313 and were delivered to 13,857 numbers, a 97 per cent strike rate as 9,485 of them read it; it failed to land at the remaining 3,401 numbers. The recovery on May 19 was ₹37.24 crore in 1,479 cases. The full impact of recovery received beyond May 19 is still being assessed, sources in the ESIC said, adding that it is likely to cross ₹150 crores.

A major portion of dues are held up due to legal issues, closures, bankruptcies and untraceable employers.

SC notice on Jharkhand exam irregularities plea

Krishnadas Rajagopal
New Delhi

The Supreme Court on Monday issued notice to the State of Jharkhand and the Jharkhand Public Service Commission on a petition seeking an independent, time-bound Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) probe into alleged malpractices in the Jharkhand Combined Civil Services Preliminary Examination.

A Bench, headed by the Chief Justice of India Surya

Kant, was hearing a petition filed by activist Harisharan Devgan, represented by senior advocate Manan Kumar Mishra and Satyam Singh Rajput.

Students had been protesting for over a month against alleged malpractices in the State-conducted exam, Mishra said.

It was imperative to have the allegations in the case probed by an independent agency, such as the CBI, rather than the State Criminal Investigation Department (CID), which is cur-



rently investigating the case, he added.

The petitioner sought an

impartial probe into public officials and the examination agencies.

Accountability should be fixed and wrongdoers should brought to justice despite the State government’s move to cancel the examination, the petition argued.

DIGITAL EVIDENCE

The plea urged the court to intervene and ensure that physical and digital evidence were secure and remain untampered.

These include the original and candidate-held optical

J&K framing roadmap to double economy with new investments and growth drivers

Gulzar Bhat
Srinagar

The Jammu & Kashmir government is working on a roadmap to double the size of its economy, with the administration looking to identify new investments and growth drivers as it seeks to move beyond traditional sectors and strengthen private-sector participation.

The roadmap to double the GSDP economy is among 16 initiatives currently under active development by the Centre for Innovation and Transformation in Governance (CITaG), alongside the Ease of Doing Business benchmarking and business-process re-engineering of the J&K Single Window System. Another 36 initiatives have been structured for implementation through 2027.



Officials involved in the exercise said the focus is expected to be on identifying sectors capable of generating sustained investment, employment and productivity gains, rather than relying on a single industry to drive growth.

GROWTH FOCUS

“The objective is to translate policy interventions into measurable economic outcomes and create an environment in which private investment can contribute

more significantly to growth,” an official familiar with the policy work said.

Against an original target of 28 deliverables by August 2026, the organisation has tracked 100 knowledge-out-put projects.

Of these, 21 have been completed, while another 20 strategic frameworks are under review.

The completed work includes the J&K Electric Vehicle Policy 2026, the Circular Economy Policy 2026, the Compressed Bio-Gas Policy and urban and rural mobility plans.

Frameworks under review include an FDI framework, a J&K GCC Policy 2026 and an Agri-Startup Policy.

For J&K, the challenge will be converting these policy initiatives into actual investment and productive capacity. The administration is already seeking to build an investment pipeline through

public-private partnerships, with projects spanning tourism, real estate, renewable energy, infrastructure and industrial development.

CITaG is providing project-development and transactional support for 76 PPP projects, of which 27 are active and 10 are at the development stage.

The proposed GCC Summit in October and an Energy Summit planned for December are also intended to attract investment and create employment, while a Real Estate Conclave is being planned to facilitate private investment in identified assets.

KEY COMPONENT

Officials said, “A key component will be the re-engineering of the J&K Single Window System, which is expected to streamline interactions between investors and government departments.”

Post SIR, Karnataka has over 4.46 cr voters on draft electoral rolls: CEO Anbukkumar

Press Trust of India
Bengaluru

Karnataka has over 4.46 crore voters as per the draft electoral rolls published on Monday following the SIR process, State CEO V Anbukkumar said.

According to data shared by the CEO’s office, a total of 1.07 crore electors (19.48 per cent) have been marked as absent, shifted, dead, duplicate and others (ASDDO).

Bengaluru Urban district, including the BBMP limits, has 1.03 crore, of which 46.82 lakh figure in the ASDDO list.

TOTAL ELECTORS

The total electors were 5.54 crore as on June 16.

Anbukkumar said that as part of the SIR process, the house-to-house verification exercise was conducted from

Karnataka electoral roll		
Reason	No. of electors	(%)
Absent	15,17,042	2.74
Shifted	65,45,679	11.81
Dead	16,39,864	2.96
Duplicate	7,09,870	1.28
Others	3,83,884	0.69
Total	1,07,96,339	19.48
Total electors -5,54,32,314		
Source: CEO		

June 30 to August 17.

Addressing a press conference here, the Chief Electoral Officer (CEO) said, “As we are publishing the draft electoral roll today, the names of 4.46 crore electors will be included.” Of them 2.21 crore are male voters, 2.24 crore female and 2,871 voters under the ‘other’ category, he added.

“The number of voters aged between 18 and 19 years is 3.7 lakh. The number of Persons with Disabilities (PwD) electors is 5.55 lakh.

There are 951 NRI electors and 44,176 service electors,” Anbukkumar said.

GENERAL ELECTORS

According to him, the total number of general electors is 4.46 crore and service electors 44,186.

“Among these electors, 1.75 crore have completed self-mapping, which amounts to 39.42 per cent and 2.46 crore have completed progeny mapping, which amounts to 55.32 per cent. The number of electors who have not provided any mapping information is 23.45 lakh,” he said.

Analysing the age-wise data, the CEO said that the number of voters aged above 85 years is around 3.92 lakh.

“Keeping in mind the Election Commission’s direction that there should not be more than 1,200 electors at any polling station, around 1,873 polling sta-

tions have now been added. With this, the total number of polling stations in Karnataka is now 60,923, which was earlier 59,050,” he said.

The CEO said that so far, they had received 4.73 lakh Form 6 applications, 3,880 Form 6A applications, around 67,000 Form 7 applications, and 9.23 lakh Form 8 applications. These are for first time voters, overseas citizens, requesting deletions from the voter list and for updates. “In total, 4.76 lakh forms have been received,” he said.

The period for filing claims and objections will be from August 24 to September 23, 2026, while the notice phase and disposal of claims and objections will continue from August 24 to October 22, 2026.

The final electoral roll will be published on October 27, 2026.

India may miss its ambitious target of achieving exports worth \$1 trillion during 2026-27 due to the global uncertainties, in general, and the tariff war, in particular, according to NITI Aayog Vice-Chairman Ashok Kumar Lahiri.

Lahiri pointed out that the country needs to diversify its export basket, “States of origin” and export destinations in order to grow its shipments amid geopolitical uncertainties. “India’s exports are heavily concentrated in a small group of product categories, led by engineering goods, refined petroleum, electronics, gems and jewellery and pharmaceuticals. Moreover, just five States, Maharashtra, Gujarat, Tamil Nadu, Karnataka and Uttar Pradesh, account for nearly 70 per cent of the country’s total shipments. We need to diversify both our export basket as well as our States of origin and export destinations,” Lahiri said during an event of Bandhan Bank in Kolkata on Sunday.

GLOBAL VALUE CHAIN

The NITI Aayog Vice-Chairman said rising exports will help India modernise its technology and product quality, and also help the country in integrating with the global value chain and attract foreign investment.

Notably, Union Minister of Commerce and Industry Piyush Goyal in May said India had set a target of achieving exports worth \$1 trillion this year and \$2 trillion over the next five years.

Due to geopolitical risks and uncertainties, Indian exports were affected, and its trade gap widened in July as imports grew faster than exports, with the combined



Ashok Kumar Lahiri, Vice-Chairman, NITI Aayog

“We need to diversify both our export basket as well as our States of origin and export destinations,” Lahiri said

merchandise and services deficit rising 31.5 per cent y-o-y to slightly over \$15 billion, Lahiri said.

He further said the disruption in world supply of oil, gas and fertilizer had led to significant stiffening of their prices. “Times are hard and not conducive, but the Indian economy has held up well. Reforms have not stopped and neither should they. As the saying goes, every crisis is an opportunity — to mend our ways, improve ourselves as well as the system,” he added.

On its 11th anniversary day on Sunday, Bandhan Bank marked a major milestone in its growth journey with the launch of its 2,000th branch in Chennai’s Egmore. With this, the private sector lender’s total banking outlets across the country touched 6,400.

The bank also unveiled mBandhan Lite, a mobile banking application designed for microfinance customers to make digital banking accessible and inclusive.

With full occupancy, IIT-Madras Research Park to add 1.2 million sq ft of space in 12-18 months

Our Bureau
Chennai

Twenty years after its formation as India’s first university-linked research park, the Indian Institute of Technology-Madras Research Park (IIT-M RP) is gearing up for further expansion with plans to commission another 1.2 million sq ft of workspace in the next 12-18 months.

The research park’s Phase Three expansion will be spread across six new buildings with construction expected to commence this quarter, the organisation said in its FY26 annual report.

FULL UP

The build-out comes at a time when the IIT-M RP has achieved an occupancy rate of 99 per cent with 41 clients

added in the financial year ended March 2026, as against 32 clients onboarded in the preceding fiscal.

Overall, the research park’s clientele stood at 192 as of March 2026, which included 95 industrial R&D centres, 59 start-ups, 17 centres of excellence (CoEs) and 3 incubators and 18 other enablers.

Interestingly, IIT-M RP witnessed a 20 per cent change in its client portfolio in FY26 as part of a cycle of new onboardings, expansions and exits, according to additional information made available to *businessline* by IIT-MRP.

NEW CLIENTS

“Our new clients are increasingly aligned with our strategic focus on frontier technology sectors. The clients onboarded this year included

companies operating in frontier strategic technologies across AI, semiconductors, aerospace, sustainability, healthcare and advanced manufacturing,” the RP said.

Some noteworthy additions to IIT-M RP’s ecosystem in FY26 included German advanced optics and optoelectronics Zeiss, semiconductor start-up Vyoma Systems, spacetechnology SatLabs, healthcare start-up ISMO Bio-Photonics and Murugappa Group’s Coromandel.

KEY DEVELOPMENTS

Among key developments this year are IIT-M RP’s launch of a ₹600 crore IIT-Madras Unicorn Frontier Fund, which will distribute capital in the range of ₹5-10 crore to support start-ups working in areas such as defence, climate tech, quantum

computing and semiconductors, among others.

In FY26, the Research Park, in collaboration with the Government of Tamil Nadu, announced plans for the development of a Centre for Advanced Semiconductor Technologies (CoAS) as a centre to integrate fabrication, packaging, testing, applied research and industry-driven innovation and capture the \$1 trillion semiconductor opportunity.

The Research Park, working closely with the IIT-Madras Incubation Cell, has supported over 580 ventures collectively valued about \$8.5 billion.

The ecosystem also includes over 250 research focused labs across 17 sectors. These organisations have collectively created over 13,000 job opportunities and filed over 700 patents.



V Sajeew Kumar
Kochi

Keralam’s seafood sector has launched a major sustainability push, unveiling a comprehensive draft State Fisheries Management Plan and a digital tracking framework to capture a larger share of the growing global market for responsibly sourced seafood.

At a high-level stakeholder summit hosted by the Seafood Exporters Association of India (SEAI), government officials, marine scientists and exporters agreed to a unified roadmap designed to earn the prestigious Marine Stewardship Council (MSC) certification for the State’s key shrimp and cephalopod fisheries within the year.

Central to the initiative is the new draft Keralam State

work ensures that Keralam’s seafood remains highly competitive, fully compliant and recognised globally for responsible practices.

ONLINE REGISTRATIONS

To meet stringent international trade standards, the Marine Products Export Development Authority (MPEDA) announced that it will launch mandatory online registration for all local fish dealers and aggregators next month. The system will create an end-to-end digital audit trail from coastal landing centres directly to processing plants. Concurrently, the Fisheries department is deploying digital trawl footprint tracking and a mobile enforcement application, alongside making square-mesh codends mandatory to protect juvenile fish stocks.

Innovations backed by the MSC Ocean Stewardship Fund and presented by the ICAR-Central Institute of Fisheries Technology demonstrate that modified trawl gear is already yielding significant reductions in fuel consumption, carbon emissions, and non-target by-catch across the deep-sea fleet.

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QUICKLY.

USFDA inspects facility of Aurobindo subsidiary



Hyderabad: The United States Food and Drug Administration (USFDA) has concluded a routine inspection at Lannett Company, a wholly-owned step-down subsidiary Aurobindo Pharma at Seymour with four observations. “The inspection concluded with four observations, which are procedural in nature, and we will respond to the USFDA within the stipulated timeline,” Aurobindo informed the BSE on Monday. OUR BUREAU

Iran warns of penalties for violating Hormuz rules

Iran has issued a warning that vessels violating its arrangements for transiting the Strait of Hormuz could face restrictions, including fines, detention or confiscation, the Persian Gulf Strait Authority wrote in a post on X. Ships seeking the removal of their names from the non-compliant vessels' list must submit a request with explanations to Iran's maritime authorities, it said. REUTERS

Pvt operators expected to pump in ₹8,622 crore in 11 AAI airports

BIG BET. The investment will be spread across 5 airport bundles with expected equity returns of up to 18.6%

Rohit Vaid
New Delhi



NEW PROJECTS. The five bundles are Amritsar-Kangra, Varanasi-Gaya-Kushinagar, Bhubaneswar-Hubballi, Raipur-Aurangabad and Tiruchirappalli-Tirupati

Private concessionaires are expected to invest around ₹8,622 crore across 11 Airports Authority of India (AAI) airports proposed to be leased out in five bundles, documents reviewed by *businessline* showed.

On August 23, *businessline* reported that the Public Private Partnership Appraisal Committee (PPPAC) had given in-principle approval to the five bundled concessions.

The five bundles are Amritsar-Kangra, Varanasi-Gaya-Kushinagar, Bhubaneswar-Hubballi, Raipur-Aurangabad and Tiruchirappalli-Tirupati.

The Ministry of Civil Aviation (MoCA) will now undertake market sounding with potential infrastructure players before incorporating feedback into the proposal and submitting it to PPPAC for its final recommendation.

The Bhubaneswar-Hubballi bundle has the highest estimated investment re-

quirement at ₹2,725 crore, followed by Varanasi-Gaya-Kushinagar at ₹2,467 crore.

Raipur-Aurangabad has an estimated investment requirement of ₹1,496 crore, while Tiruchirappalli-Tirupati and Amritsar-Kangra have requirements of ₹1,411 crore and ₹523 crore respectively.

EQUITY RETURNS

Meanwhile, the Centre has estimated equity returns of up to 18.6 per cent for the five proposed airport bundles.

The Varanasi-Gaya-Kushinagar bundle has the highest projected equity internal rate of return (EIRR) at 18.6

per cent, with its project internal rate of return (PIRR) estimated at 12 per cent.

In addition, the projected EIRR for Amritsar-Kangra stands at 17.5 per cent, while its PIRR is estimated at 11.5 per cent.

For Tiruchirappalli-Tirupati, the EIRR and PIRR have been estimated at 16.7 per cent and 10.7 per cent respectively.

FINANCIAL VIABILITY

Likewise, Bhubaneswar-Hubballi has a projected EIRR of 16.4 per cent and PIRR of 11.9 per cent, while Raipur-Aurangabad has an EIRR of 16.7 per cent and PIRR of 11.6 per cent, ac-

cording to the documents.

Besides, the proposed concession structure envisages making city-side land available to private concessionaires to enhance the financial viability of the respective airport bundles.

BID DOCUMENTS

The portion of land to be made available at each airport, along with the permissible scope and nature of city-side development, will be specified in the bid documents and the draft concession agreement, the documents showed.

As per the document, the proposed revenue streams will include aeronautical, non-aeronautical and city-side development revenues.

Furthermore, aeronautical revenues include landing, housing and parking charges, cargo, ground handling, fuel throughput and user development fee.

On the other hand, non-aeronautical revenues include duty-free, food and beverage, retail, car parking, car rental and reservations, advertising and miscellaneous revenue.

Additionally, city-side development, including real estate, has been identified as a potential revenue source under the proposed structure.

The document further showed that the five-bundle structure emerged after a wider assessment undertaken by AAI.

AAI had initially assessed 12 major airports based on passenger traffic, land availability, commercial potential, financial performance and airport-specific strengths and constraints.

It subsequently evaluated 136 smaller airports for possible bundling with the major airports, considering parameters including traffic potential, capital expenditure requirements, geographical proximity, city-side development potential and financial viability.

MULTIPLE ROUNDS

Following multiple rounds of filtering and assessment of alternative major-small airport combinations, the AAI Board approved a proposal comprising five major airports bundled with six smaller airports.

United Peela Interface in bread



Amul Decades of taste

Separate licence rule for outsourced sterilisation scrapped

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Medical device manufacturers will no longer need a separate licence when they outsource the sterilisation of their products to a facility that already has a valid licence under the Medical Devices Rules, 2017, said changes notified by the Union Ministry of Health and Family Welfare.

Earlier, manufacturers had to obtain a separate loan licence even when they sent their products to an outside sterilisation facility that was already licensed under the rules.

This created an additional regulatory requirement for firms using third-party sterilisation services.

The government has now removed this requirement. Manufacturers can outsource sterilisation without obtaining a separate loan licence, provided the facility carrying out the sterilisation has a valid licence under the Medical Devices Rules, 2017.

However, the licence number of the sterilisation facility will have to be mentioned on the label of the

medical device. This will ensure that the facility responsible for sterilisation can be identified and the process remains traceable.

Officials at the Union Ministry of Health and Family Welfare said the change is aimed at simplifying compliance, reducing paperwork and supporting ease of doing business for the medical device industry.

TRANSITION PERIOD

The Ministry has also provided manufacturers a six-month transition period to comply with the new labelling requirement related to outsourced sterilisation.

Meanwhile, the government has also added the European Union to the list of stringent regulatory jurisdictions recognised under the Medical Devices Rules.

The list already includes the US, the UK, Australia, Canada and Japan.

This change will allow certain medical devices approved by stringent regulators in these jurisdictions to get a waiver from the requirement of conducting a clinical investigation in India, subject to the applicable conditions.

Foreign medical graduates protest over June exam, seek reforms

Ankita Upadhyay
New Delhi

Around 1,000 foreign medical graduates (FMGs) are sitting on a protest at Maharaaja Ranjit Singh Park in Gautam Nagar, near AIIMS Delhi, demanding transparency and reforms in the Foreign Medical Graduate Examination (FMGE) conducted on June 28, 2026.

One of the protesters, Dr Jaswant Singh Yadav, is also on a fast, as the students press the authorities to ad-

dress their concerns over the examination and its evaluation.

The protesters have written to Union Health Minister JP Nadda, seeking his intervention in the matter and urging the authorities to address their concerns over the examination and its outcome.

According to Dr Jaswant Singh Yadav, national executive member and representative for the All FMGs Association (AFA) and AIIMS Foreign Medical Students Wing, the protest follows

widespread concerns among foreign medical graduates over the difficulty and format of the June FMGE.

“Students have particularly objected to the introduction of unexpected and time-consuming video-based questions, which they claim were not adequately communicated in advance.

According to the protesters, the additional time provided during the examination was insufficient to compensate for the time required to understand and answer such questions,” he

said.

He added that the students are seeking compensatory or grace marks, or an appropriate reduction in the qualifying cut-off, depending on the assessment of the impact of the questions.

“Transparency in the examination process is another major demand. The students want NBEMS to release the official answer key and individual response sheets so that candidates can verify their answers and understand how their papers were evaluated. They have also

sought a mechanism through which disputed or questionable questions can be reviewed,” he said.

The concerns have been raised against the backdrop of a sharp decline in the pass rate in the June FMGE. The protesters say that any major change in the question pattern should be communicated well in advance, as students prepare according to the established format of the screening examination.

LETTER TO GOVT
Foreign Medical Students’

Wing of the All India Medical Students’ Association (AIMSA) has separately written to Nadda seeking his intervention.

In its representation, the association has highlighted concerns relating to the examination pattern, transparency, examination-centre facilities and the need for greater accountability.

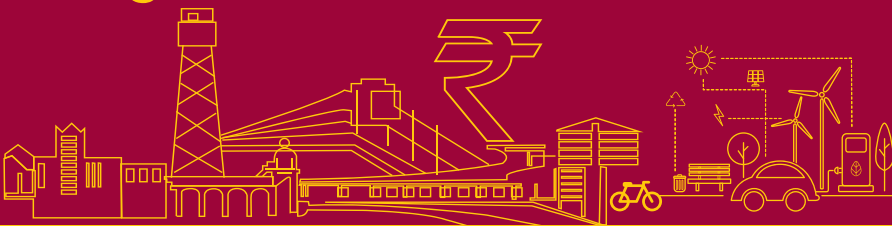
According to the protesting students, around 40,000 foreign medical graduates are affected by the concerns surrounding the June examination.



“We are repurposing ourselves to meet the needs of a New India, guided by a ‘T-shaped’ growth philosophy—deepening our core strengths in housing and urban infrastructure finance while expanding our capabilities across the urban development ecosystem.”

SANJAY KULSHRESTHA
Chairman & Managing Director

Financing Infrastructure for Viksit Bharat



Excerpts of the Chairman’s Message on the Occasion of 56th Annual General Meeting

Distinguished Shareholders, Ladies and Gentlemen,

“It is my great privilege and honour to welcome you all to the 56th Annual General Meeting of HUDCO. I want to thank you for your continued trust and confidence, which has enabled HUDCO to become a diversified Infrastructure Finance Company aligned with the national vision of *Viksit Bharat 2047*. Guided by our commitment to *‘Financing Infrastructure for Viksit Bharat’*, HUDCO remains a key contributor to India’s development.

Let me begin by reflecting on the broader economic environment in which your Company operated this financial year.

The year brought significant global changes, including geopolitical uncertainties, shifting trade patterns, technological disruption, climate concerns, and evolving economic dynamics. Despite



these challenges, India remained one of the fastest-growing major economies, supported by strong domestic demand, prudent macroeconomic management and sustained infrastructure development.

Looking ahead, India’s sustained, inclusive and transformative growth will be shaped by its cities.

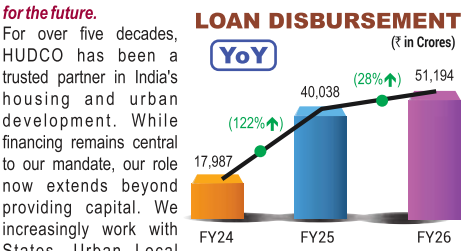
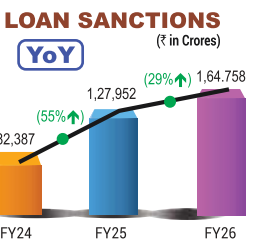
As India moves toward a \$30 trillion economy, urbanisation will be fulcrum to long-term growth. Well-planned cities with quality infrastructure will drive investment, employment, innovation and productivity. While major metropolitan centres will remain growth engines, Tier-II and Tier-III cities will increasingly lead the next phase, fostering balanced and inclusive regional development.

Urban development is fundamentally about improving citizens’ daily lives, not just building infrastructure.

For HUDCO, this is both an opportunity and a responsibility. We must learn from global best practices and adapt them to our context. The next phase of urban transformation must follow an integrated approach that connects housing, mobility, public services, environmental sustainability and economic development. This approach is essential for building **climate and disaster-resilient, economically vibrant, and socially inclusive cities**. A systems-based perspective, where sector investments reinforce each other, will create lasting value and support the vision of *‘Viksit Bharat by 2047’*.

Planning models such as Transit Oriented Development, mixed-use development, and 15-minute neighbourhoods are based on the principle that citizens should be able to access homes, workplaces, schools, healthcare, and essential services with ease.

In this context, it is important to understand how your Company is positioning itself



for the future.

For over five decades, HUDCO has been a trusted partner in India’s housing and urban development. While financing remains central to our mandate, our role now extends beyond providing capital. We increasingly work with States, Urban Local Bodies, (ULBs) and public institutions throughout the project lifecycle, from conceptualisation to financial closure. In doing so, we help to **create better urban outcomes and support cities** that are more productive, resilient and sustainable.

As India evolves, HUDCO is guided by a **‘T-shaped’ growth philosophy**: deepening our core strengths in housing and urban infrastructure ecosystem while expanding capabilities across the urban development ecosystem. Our mission remains unchanged, what is evolving is not the mandate, but the way we deliver it. Making our approach more responsive, efficient and aligned with emerging needs. As cities require strong institutions, empowered ULBs, sound governance, and sustainable municipal finances, we are seeing a shift from a grant-based approach to a more reform-oriented, challenge-driven and investment-led model of urban development.

One such transformative initiative is the Urban Invest Window (UIWIN). HUDCO under guidance of MoHUA has launched UIWIN on 8th November 2025, as a dedicated platform to strengthen ULBs and accelerate the development of future-ready, financially sustainable, inclusive and climate-resilient cities. Moving beyond conventional project financing, UIWIN provides end-to-end support—from project conceptualisation, preparation and structuring to capacity building, financial advisory and access to funding.

It creates a collaborative **U win, I win and We win** ecosystem by bringing together ULBs, HUDCO, multilateral development banks, financial institutions and institutional investors. By helping cities develop a credible pipeline of bankable and investment-ready urban infrastructure projects, UIWIN seeks to unlock diverse sources of domestic and global capital and translate urban aspirations into sustainable, citizen-centric infrastructure.

Your Company continued to leverage the strategic advantages of its **Navratna status and NBFC-IFC** positioning, providing greater operational flexibility and wider access to infrastructure financing opportunities. The Company strengthened engagement across infrastructure sectors and expanded presence in **PPP projects**.

Your Company advanced **asset monetisation** of its strategically located land parcels and real estate portfolio, expected to unlock considerable value. Further, momentum in **digital transformation** through ERP systems, E-Office adoption and increasing digitisation has strengthened operational efficiency and transparency.

Your Company maintained one of the strongest **asset quality** profiles in the sector through focused recovery efforts and proactive risk management; Strengthened governance architecture through enhanced risk management, compliance oversight and information security frameworks.

Your Company diversified its **resource mobilisation** through ECBs, Section 85 Capital Gain Bonds, ESG-linked borrowings and HUDCO’s maiden Perpetual Bond issuance. These initiatives contributed to a lower cost of funds, a stronger capital base and more resilient asset-liability profile. Your Company initiated repurposing of Human Settlement Management Institute (HSMI) into a more effective, contemporary and future-ready institution, aligned with HUDCO’s expanding role. The objective is to evolve HSMI beyond a conventional training institute into a Centre of Excellence.

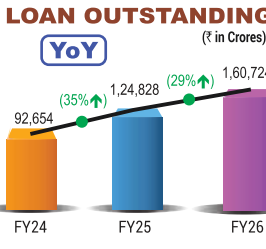
Your company continued the **CSR initiatives** supporting the theme of health and nutrition and other sectors of sanitation, renewable energy, and community infrastructure. The ESG agenda has been strengthened by financing projects that deliver measurable environmental and social outcomes.

Your company undertook **comprehensive policy reviews** covering lending, resource mobilisation, consultancy services, human resources, and governance. Investment in organisational capabilities through recruitment, leadership development, and succession planning by including more than 150 officers over the last two years, ensuring HUDCO remains future ready.

These strategic initiatives and institutional reforms have resulted in one of the strongest years of operational and financial performance in HUDCO’s history.

Shareholders, it is gratifying to report that during Financial Year 2025-26, your Company’s growth trajectory remained robust, reflecting the strength of its business model:

- Highest-ever annual loan sanctions of **₹1,64,758 crore**, up **29%**.
- All-time high loan disbursements of **₹51,194 crore**, up **28%**.
- Loan book expanded to **₹1,60,724 crore** (from **₹1,24,828 crore**).
- Total income up **29%** to **₹13,327 crore**; net profit at a historic high of **₹4,034 crore**, up nearly **49%**.
- Net worth strengthened to **₹21,977 crore**.
- Gross NPA at **1.04%** and Net NPA at **0.05%**, with provision coverage of **94.90%**; **₹402.96 crore** recovered from outstanding NPAs.
- Mobilised **₹ 67,503 crore** in FY26, compared to **₹ 51,133 crore** raised in Previous FY, including **₹ 5,400 crore (92 billion JPY)** through ECB. The efficient treasury management enabled us to reduce the overall cost of borrowings by 27 basis points from **7.44%** in FY25 to **7.17%** in FY26. Further, your company is also availing ECB facilities under the RBI’s USD-INR swap facility.
- Capital Adequacy Ratio at a healthy **39.93%**, well above the regulatory requirement of 15%.
- Board recommended the highest-ever

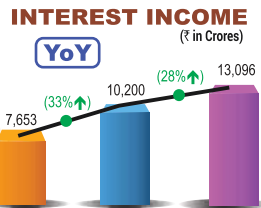


dividend of **₹6.05 per equity share**, aggregating to **₹1,211.15 crore**, including a final dividend of **₹1.50 per share**, subject to shareholder approval.

- Secured ‘Excellent’ MoU Rating for the second consecutive year; market capitalisation crossed **₹44,000 crore**.
- Maintained the highest domestic credit ratings of **AAA/Stable**, with international ratings aligned with India’s sovereign ratings, and ESG ratings reflecting continued commitment to responsible value creation. These achievements reflect strong governance, prudent risk management, stakeholder confidence, and above all, the dedication of Team HUDCO.

Dear Shareholders, while our performance in FY 2025-26 has been encouraging, your Company remains focused on the opportunities ahead. The opportunities before us are significant and span the entire urban development value chain:

- India’s goal to become a developed nation by 2047 will require unprecedented infrastructure investment. The World Bank estimates approximately **\$840 billion (80 Lakh Crore)** will be needed by 2036, with more than half of the urban infrastructure required for 2050 is yet to be built.
 - Government initiatives such as PM Gati Shakti, the National Logistics Policy, Industrial Corridors Programme, City Economic Regions and the Urban Challenge Fund are creating a strong pipeline of projects.
 - The next phase of growth is expected to be driven by investments in industrial corridors, logistics parks, ring roads, highways, metro systems, high-speed rail, airports, ports, urban mobility, water and sanitation, affordable housing and climate-resilient infrastructure.
 - HUDCO is uniquely positioned to play a larger role by combining **long-term finance, technical advisory and institutional capacity building** thereby, helping create a robust pipeline of bankable urban infrastructure projects.
 - As the **digital economy** expands, HUDCO also sees considerable potential in supporting the digital infrastructure backbone required for technologies such as **Artificial Intelligence, GCC, Data Centre, Cloud Computing and Digital Public Infrastructure**.
 - We continue to expand engagement across PPP projects and commercially viable infrastructure sectors, while affordable housing remains a key pillar of our growth strategy.
- Supported by a strong balance sheet, sound governance and clear strategic direction, your Company remains committed to strengthening its position as the country’s premier techno-finance institution for housing and infrastructure development.



Before concluding, I wish to place on record sincere gratitude to all those who have contributed to your Company’s continued growth and success. On behalf of the Board of Directors, I convey heartfelt gratitude to the Hon’ble Minister of Housing and Urban Affairs, Hon’ble Minister of State, the Secretary and officials of the Ministry for their guidance and continued confidence in HUDCO. I gratefully acknowledge the continued support of the Ministry of Rural Development, Ministry of Finance including the Department of Economic Affairs (DEA) and Department of Financial Services (DFS), the Ministry of Corporate Affairs, the Department of Public Enterprises, Department of Personnel and Training (DoPT), RBI, NHB, SEBI, Stock Exchanges, Multilateral Development Banks and other regulatory, financial and statutory institutions. I extend sincere gratitude to Comptroller and Auditor General of India; our Statutory and Secretarial Auditors, our shareholders, bondholders, lending institutions, banks, State Governments, Housing Boards and all stakeholders for their continued trust and partnership.

Most importantly, I acknowledge the dedication and professionalism of Team HUDCO including retired employees. The transformation we are undertaking is possible only because of our employees’ collective efforts, whose hard work and commitment are the foundation of our success.

As we move forward, our commitment remains unwavering: to strengthen institutions, finance transformative infrastructure, support inclusive and sustainable urban development and improve the quality of life for millions. Together, we will continue to partner with States, cities and communities to advance the vision of a **‘Viksit Pradesh for Viksit Bharat’** and contribute meaningfully to the national aspiration of *Viksit Bharat @2047*.

Thank you. Jai Hind!

PLACE: New Delhi
DATE: 24th August, 2026

Sd/-
Sanjay Kulshrestha
Chairman & Managing Director
DIN: 06428038

This does not purport to be a record of the proceedings of the Annual General Meeting held on 24th August, 2026.



Housing and Urban Development Corporation Ltd.
(A Govt. of India Enterprise)

